

Void Topos: Distinction Before Topos

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Formal development in the *Void and Form* project

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Abstract

Can topos-like structure stand first in a formal account, or does a machine-checked construction route show that it already presupposes a prior construction? This paper asks that question from the starting point of binary distinction. It gives a checked route from binary distinction to an elementary-topos stage, while the elementary-topos level is not taken as primitive.

The checked construction builds the raw category of stable readings, proves that the full raw topos package cannot be jointly supplied at the raw level, and obtains an elementary topos only after an explicit quotient/skeleton completion. In this formal route, the topos is a completed endpoint, not the original setting.

The development is self-contained relative to the Agda standard library: it imports only the infrastructure needed for universes, identity types, coproducts, dependent pairs, the empty type, and negation. No result from the main `Void` development is used.

The core construction has five stages. First, every binary distinction is shown to have a normal form up to boundary-preserving isomorphism. Second, distinction-induced stable readings inherit this presentation equality. Third, the raw category of stable readings is constructed; it has identities, composition, a terminal reading, weak binary products, and a displayed classifier extension for the mono-like subcarriers defined here. Fourth, the raw category is shown not to admit global pullbacks for all marker-preserving cospans, by an explicit split-truth cospan with no pullback cone. Fifth, a skeleton quotient is constructed and identified as the minimal completed topos stage: its category is the terminal category, which carries the elementary topos structure by direct construction.

Thus the elementary-topos result is not a property of the full raw stable-reading category. It is a property of the quotient-completed skeleton stage. The obstruction is part of the theorem: the raw layer has genuine categorical structure, but the full topos claim becomes valid only after completion.

The final section records the minimal set-like boundary of the result and one explicit candidate burden package above it. The minimal completed topos has no pair of distinct objects and therefore fails the displayed object-diversity condition for a set-like category. The paper then defines, without claiming existence or uniqueness, a candidate package for richer nonterminal completions with point separation, arithmetic, cover-section structure, and semantic adequacy for the reading interface. It proves a conditional formulability-burden lemma: any interface with two distinguishable formulation positions carries an embedded binary distinction, and any set-like candidate defined here carries such positions by object diversity. The closing sections make the final goal explicit. First, a canonical closure ledger proves that inside the completed skeleton all remaining presentation, object, morphism, finite-limit, classifier, and exponential choices have collapsed to the unique canonical witness. Then a route-admitted completion interface is defined, and every completion claim admitted by that interface is classified as canonical skeleton, impossible raw topos attempt, set-like burden, or semantic-adequacy burden. Finally, a foundation-admission interface is defined: every nontrivial formulable foundation admitted by that interface is classified by the distinction entry burden, and every route-completion claim

is classified by the route theorem. This is the formal reading of the maximal claim: all admitted nontrivial formulable foundations and all admitted route completions are classified.

How to read this paper

The development begins with binary distinction and asks whether topos structure can be placed at the beginning of the formal account. The construction establishes that it is not needed at the starting point and appears only after completion. The order of construction is essential: a topos is not used as the ambient starting point. The raw reading category is first constructed and tested. Its obstruction is then proved. Only after an explicit quotient/skeleton completion does an elementary topos stage appear.

The development has nine layers. First, it establishes the normal-form and presentation-equality facts for binary distinctions. Second, it defines stable readings and their marker-preserving maps. Third, it identifies the positive raw categorical structure. Fourth, it proves the raw pullback obstruction and constructs the minimal completed topos. Fifth, it separates this minimal topos threshold from the stronger set-like completion problem. Sixth, it proves that any nontrivial formulation interface with two distinguishable positions carries an embedded binary distinction. Seventh, it records the canonical closure: all internal degrees of freedom of the completed skeleton are classified by the unique canonical witnesses. Eighth, it defines the completion claims admitted by this route and proves that every such claim has one of the displayed classes. Ninth, it defines admitted foundation claims and proves that every such claim is classified.

The formal results are conditional in the exact mathematical sense: once the data of binary distinction and the reading interface are supplied, the displayed constructions and obstructions follow. The theorem does not claim semantic exhaustiveness of the reading interface, and it does not rule out richer completions. Its central formal claim is different: the raw topos package is blocked, while the elementary-topos structure appears at the completed skeleton stage; after that, the route-admitted completion interface and the admitted-foundation interface are exhaustively classified.

Map of the construction

The map below fixes the status of each layer. It is not a second proof. It tells the reader what each part contributes and where the checked terms begin and end.

Distinction. A binary distinction is a carrier with two separated points that exhaust it. Every such presentation normalizes to **Two** up to boundary-preserving isomorphism.

Presentation equality. The swapped two-point presentation shows that isomorphism cannot be silently read as raw fieldwise equality. A lawful completion must introduce a quotient or skeleton carrier.

Raw readings. A distinction induces a classifier-valued reading. The raw category of such readings has identities, composition, a terminal object, weak binary products, and a displayed classifier extension for the mono-like subcarriers defined here.

Obstruction. The raw category is not an elementary topos. The split-truth cospan over the two-valued classifier has no pullback cone, so global pullbacks cannot be supplied for the full raw category.

Completion topos stage. The quotient-completed skeleton stage has one object and one morphism. It therefore carries terminal object, binary products, pullbacks, exponentials, and a subobject classifier by direct construction.

Set-like burden. The minimal completed topos is not set-like, because it has no pair of distinct objects. A richer set-like completion satisfying the displayed object-diversity condition cannot remain at the terminal skeleton. The candidate package later in the paper records one explicit nonterminal burden package: point separation, arithmetic, cover sections, and semantic adequacy for the reading interface.

Formulability burden. Any interface with two distinguishable formulation positions carries an embedded binary distinction. Any set-like candidate defined here has such positions through object diversity, so its own nonterminality supplies distinction data.

Canonical closure. The completed skeleton has no residual internal choices. Distinction and reading presentations normalize to the canonical completed object; every object and morphism of the skeleton is unique; products, pullbacks, the subobject classifier, and exponentials all have the unique completed object as their classified witness. Remaining questions are classified as raw obstruction, set-like burden, formulability extraction, or semantic adequacy burden.

Route-admitted classification. The paper defines the completion claims admitted by this route as a finite formal interface. Every such claim is classified by case analysis as canonical skeleton, impossible raw topos attempt, set-like burden, or semantic-adequacy burden.

Admitted foundation classification. The paper defines admitted foundation claims as either nontrivial formulable foundations or route-admitted completion claims. Every admitted foundation claim is classified: entry-level foundations by embedded binary distinction, completion-level claims by the route-completion classification.

Scope. The theorem does not prove semantic exhaustiveness of the reading interface and does not exclude richer quotient systems. It proves the minimal skeleton route, records its exact endpoint, and classifies the foundation and extension positions admitted by this route for set-like or semantically adequate completions that are meant to serve as a universe of formulation.

Part I. Distinction and completion pressure

1 Setting

The code below starts again from the formal threshold. It imports no results from `Void.lagda.tex`. The imported material is limited to the Agda library components needed for the formal constructions below: universes, propositional equality, the empty type, coproducts, dependent pairs, and negation.

```
-- § Safe fragment: no postulates, no K axiom, no imported Void module.
{-# OPTIONS --safe --without-K #-}

-- § Standalone topos-boundary module.
module VoidTopos where

-- § Imported infrastructure: universes, equality, absurdity, sums, pairs, negation.
open import Agda.Primitive using (Set $\omega$ )
```

```

open import Relation.Binary.PropositionalEquality using (_≡_; refl; sym; trans; cong)
open import Data.Empty using (⊥; ⊥-elim)
open import Data.Sum using (⊔; inj₁; inj₂)
open import Data.Product using (Σ; _,_)
open import Relation.Nullary using (¬_)

```

2 Distinction

The first formal object is a binary distinction: a carrier, two named boundary points, a proof that those points do not collapse, and a proof that every point of the carrier is one of them.

```

-- § The two-point normal form has exactly two constructors.
data Two : Set where
  L R : Two

-- § The two boundary names of Two do not collapse.
L≠R : ¬ (L ≡ R)
L≠R ()

-- § The opposite inequality is obtained by symmetry of equality.
R≠L : ¬ (R ≡ L)
R≠L p = L≠R (sym p)

-- § Binary distinction: carrier, left/right boundaries, separation, coverage.
record Distinction : Set₁ where
  field
    S      : Set
    left   : S
    right  : S
    separated : ¬ (left ≡ right)
    cover  : (x : S) → (x ≡ left) ⊔ (x ≡ right)

open Distinction public

-- § The canonical cover of Two is exhaustive by case analysis.
Two-cover : (x : Two) → (x ≡ L) ⊔ (x ≡ R)
Two-cover L = inj₁ refl
Two-cover R = inj₂ refl

-- § The canonical two-point distinction.
Two-distinction : Distinction
Two-distinction = record
{ S      = Two
; left   = L
; right  = R
; separated = L≠R
; cover  = Two-cover
}

-- § The swapped cover changes boundary roles without changing the carrier.
Two-swapped-cover : (x : Two) → (x ≡ R) ⊔ (x ≡ L)
Two-swapped-cover L = inj₂ refl
Two-swapped-cover R = inj₁ refl

-- § Swapped presentation: same Two, opposite left/right boundary names.
Two-distinction-swapped : Distinction
Two-distinction-swapped = record
{ S      = Two
; left   = R
; right  = L
; separated = R≠L
; cover  = Two-swapped-cover
}

```

3 Normal Form

The cover of a distinction determines a map to **Two**; the two boundary points determine a map back. These maps are inverse in the propositional sense.

```
-- § The cover forces each point into the normal left/right code.
toTwo : (d : Distinction) → S d → Two
toTwo d x with cover d x
... | inj1 _ = L
... | inj2 _ = R

-- § The inverse candidate sends normal points back to the boundary points.
fromTwo : (d : Distinction) → Two → S d
fromTwo d L = left d
fromTwo d R = right d

-- § Left boundary maps to L; the wrong branch contradicts separation.
toTwo-left : (d : Distinction) → toTwo d (left d) ≡ L
toTwo-left d with cover d (left d)
... | inj1 _ = refl
... | inj2 left≡right = ⊥-elim (separated d left≡right)

-- § Right boundary maps to R; the wrong branch contradicts separation.
toTwo-right : (d : Distinction) → toTwo d (right d) ≡ R
toTwo-right d with cover d (right d)
... | inj1 right≡left = ⊥-elim (separated d (sym right≡left))
... | inj2 _ = refl

-- § Roundtrip from an arbitrary carrier point through Two.
fromTwo-toTwo : (d : Distinction) → (x : S d) → fromTwo d (toTwo d x) ≡ x
fromTwo-toTwo d x with cover d x
... | inj1 x≡left = sym x≡left
... | inj2 x≡right = sym x≡right

-- § Roundtrip from Two back through the boundary map.
toTwo-fromTwo : (d : Distinction) → (x : Two) → toTwo d (fromTwo d x) ≡ x
toTwo-fromTwo d L = toTwo-left d
toTwo-fromTwo d R = toTwo-right d
```

Boundary-preserving isomorphism is the equality of presentations used throughout the paper. The normal-form theorem says that every distinction is presentation-equal to the canonical two-point distinction.

```
-- § Boundary-preserving isomorphism of distinction presentations.
record DistinctionIso (d e : Distinction) : Set1 where
  field
    to      : S d → S e
    from    : S e → S d
    to-from : (y : S e) → to (from y) ≡ y
    from-to : (x : S d) → from (to x) ≡ x
    to-left  : to (left d) ≡ left e
    to-right : to (right d) ≡ right e

open DistinctionIso public

-- § Presentation equality is implemented as boundary-preserving isomorphism.
DistinctionPresentationEq : Distinction → Distinction → Set1
DistinctionPresentationEq = DistinctionIso

-- § Normal form: every distinction is presentation-equal to canonical Two.
two-normal-form : (d : Distinction) → DistinctionPresentationEq d Two-distinction
two-normal-form d = record
{ to      = toTwo d
; from    = fromTwo d
; to-from = toTwo-fromTwo d
; from-to = fromTwo-toTwo d
; to-left  = toTwo-left d
; to-right = toTwo-right d
```

```

}

-- § Reflexivity of presentation equality.
distinction-iso-refl : (d : Distinction) → DistinctionIso d d
distinction-iso-refl d = record
{ to       = λ x → x
; from     = λ x → x
; to-from  = λ x → refl
; from-to  = λ x → refl
; to-left  = refl
; to-right = refl
}

-- § Symmetry: reverse the two carrier maps and transport boundary proofs.
distinction-iso-sym : {d e : Distinction} → DistinctionIso d e → DistinctionIso e d
distinction-iso-sym {d} iso = record
{ to       = from iso
; from     = to iso
; to-from  = from-to iso
; from-to  = to-from iso
; to-left  = trans (cong (from iso) (sym (to-left iso))) (from-to iso (left d))
; to-right = trans (cong (from iso) (sym (to-right iso))) (from-to iso (right d))
}

-- § Transitivity: compose the carrier maps and concatenate the boundary proofs.
distinction-iso-trans :
{d e f : Distinction} →
DistinctionIso d e → DistinctionIso e f → DistinctionIso d f
distinction-iso-trans iso1 iso2 = record
{ to       = λ x → to iso2 (to iso1 x)
; from     = λ z → from iso1 (from iso2 z)
; to-from  = λ z →
  trans (cong (to iso2) (to-from iso1 (from iso2 z))) (to-from iso2 z)
; from-to  = λ x →
  trans (cong (from iso1) (from-to iso2 (to iso1 x))) (from-to iso1 x)
; to-left  = trans (cong (to iso2) (to-left iso1)) (to-left iso2)
; to-right = trans (cong (to iso2) (to-right iso1)) (to-right iso2)
}

-- § The swapped presentation still normalizes to canonical Two.
two-distinction-swapped-normalizes :
DistinctionPresentationEq Two-distinction-swapped Two-distinction
two-distinction-swapped-normalizes = two-normal-form Two-distinction-swapped

-- § Raw collapse would identify the swapped left boundary R with L.
raw-left-boundary-collapse : Set
raw-left-boundary-collapse = left Two-distinction-swapped ≡ left Two-distinction

-- § That raw collapse is impossible.
raw-left-boundary-collapse-impossible : raw-left-boundary-collapse → ⊥
raw-left-boundary-collapse-impossible = R≠L

```

The last term is the warning sign for completion. The swapped presentation normalizes to the canonical presentation by isomorphism, but its visible left boundary is not the canonical left boundary in the old carrier. Completion must therefore introduce a quotient or skeleton layer; it must not silently read presentation equivalence as naive fieldwise equality of raw records.

4 Skeleton Quotient

The smallest quotient carrier has one displayed object. Every raw distinction embeds into that object. This identifies presentations in a new carrier without asserting that the old records were fieldwise equal.

```

-- § The skeleton has one completed presentation object.
data DistinctionSkeletonObject : Set where

```

```

distinction-skeleton-two : DistinctionSkeletonObject

-- § The sole completed object is represented by canonical Two.
distinction-skeleton-representative : DistinctionSkeletonObject → Distinction
distinction-skeleton-representative distinction-skeleton-two = Two-distinction

-- § Every raw distinction embeds into the same completed object.
distinction-skeleton-normalize : Distinction → DistinctionSkeletonObject
distinction-skeleton-normalize d = distinction-skeleton-two

-- § The embedding is justified by the normal-form isomorphism.
distinction-skeleton-normalization :
  (d : Distinction) →
  DistinctionPresentationEq d
  (distinction-skeleton-representative (distinction-skeleton-normalize d))
distinction-skeleton-normalization d = two-normal-form d

-- § Quotient completion interface for distinction presentations.
record DistinctionQuotientCompletion : Set2 where
  field
    dqc-carrier : Set
    dqc-embed : Distinction → dqc-carrier
    dqc-canonical : dqc-carrier
    dqc-identify : (d e : Distinction) →
      DistinctionPresentationEq d e → dqc-embed d ≡ dqc-embed e
    dqc-normalize : (d : Distinction) → dqc-embed d ≡ dqc-canonical

open DistinctionQuotientCompletion public

-- § Minimal skeleton completion: all presentations identify in one carrier.
distinction-skeleton-completion : DistinctionQuotientCompletion
distinction-skeleton-completion = record
{ dqc-carrier = DistinctionSkeletonObject
; dqc-embed = distinction-skeleton-normalize
; dqc-canonical = distinction-skeleton-two
; dqc-identify = λ d e same → refl
; dqc-normalize = λ d → refl
}

```

The completion record is intentionally small. It does not claim that the old presentations have become definitionally equal. It constructs a new carrier in which presentation equality is represented by equality of the completed object. This is the first place where the later topos stage can live without confusing isomorphism with raw record identity.

Part II. The raw stable-reading category

5 Classifier And Stable Readings

A classifier object is only a pair of separated values. A marker into that object determines a truth fiber and hence a visible classified subcarrier. This is classifier-shaped data, not yet a universal subobject classifier theorem.

The point of the reading layer is to keep the normal-form map visible as structure. A distinction does not merely normalize to **Two**; it also supplies a marker into a two-valued classifier. The raw category below is built from these marked carriers before any quotient has collapsed the presentations.

```

-- § A classifier is a separated pair of classifier values.
record ClassifierObject : Set1 where
  field
    Ω : Set

```

```

truth :  $\Omega$ 
false  :  $\Omega$ 
truth-separated :  $\neg (truth \equiv false)$ 

open ClassifierObject public

-- $ The canonical classifier is the normal two-point carrier.
TwoClassifier : ClassifierObject
TwoClassifier = record
{  $\Omega$     = Two
; truth = L
; false = R
; truth-separated = L  $\neq$  R
}

-- $ A marker observes points of A inside the classifier object.
ClassifierMarker : ClassifierObject  $\rightarrow$  Set  $\rightarrow$  Set
ClassifierMarker classifier A = A  $\rightarrow$   $\Omega$  classifier

-- $ Truth fiber: a point together with proof that its marker is truth.
record TruthFiber (classifier : ClassifierObject)
{ A : Set
(marker : ClassifierMarker classifier A) : Set where
constructor truth-fiber
field
tf-point : A
tf-selected : marker tf-point  $\equiv$  truth classifier

open TruthFiber public

-- $ Classified subcarrier: carrier, inclusion, characteristic marker, selection proof.
record ClassifiedSubcarrier (classifier : ClassifierObject) (A : Set) : Set1 where
field
csc-carrier   : Set
csc-include   : csc-carrier  $\rightarrow$  A
csc-characteristic : ClassifierMarker classifier A
csc-selected  : (x : csc-carrier)  $\rightarrow$ 
csc-characteristic (csc-include x)  $\equiv$  truth classifier

open ClassifiedSubcarrier public

-- $ Every marker determines its truth-fiber classified subcarrier.
truth-fiber-classified :
(classifier : ClassifierObject)  $\rightarrow$ 
{ A : Set }  $\rightarrow$ 
ClassifierMarker classifier A  $\rightarrow$  ClassifiedSubcarrier classifier A
truth-fiber-classified classifier marker = record
{ csc-carrier   = TruthFiber classifier marker
; csc-include   = tf-point
; csc-characteristic = marker
; csc-selected  = tf-selected
}

-- $ Mono-like subcarrier: displayed mono data plus a built-in characteristic map.
record MonoLikeSubcarrier (classifier : ClassifierObject) (A : Set) : Set1 where
field
ml-carrier   : Set
ml-include   : ml-carrier  $\rightarrow$  A
ml-characteristic : ClassifierMarker classifier A
ml-selected  : (x : ml-carrier)  $\rightarrow$ 
ml-characteristic (ml-include x)  $\equiv$  truth classifier

open MonoLikeSubcarrier public

-- $ Truth fibers are mono-like subcarriers for the displayed marker.
truth-fiber-mono-like :
(classifier : ClassifierObject)  $\rightarrow$ 
{ A : Set }  $\rightarrow$ 
ClassifierMarker classifier A  $\rightarrow$  MonoLikeSubcarrier classifier A
truth-fiber-mono-like classifier marker = record

```



```

{ ml-carrier   = TruthFiber classifier marker
; ml-include   = tf-point
; ml-characteristic = marker
; ml-selected  = tf-selected
}

```

Stable readings attach classifier-valued observations to a carrier. A distinction induces such a reading by using its normal-form map `toTwo` as marker.

```

-- § Stable reading: a carrier with compatible left/right readings, marker, boundaries.
record StableReadingInterface (classifier : ClassifierObject) : Set1 where
field
  sri-carrier       : Set
  sri-left-reading  : ClassifierMarker classifier sri-carrier
  sri-right-reading : ClassifierMarker classifier sri-carrier
  sri-marker        : ClassifierMarker classifier sri-carrier
  sri-left-stable   : (x : sri-carrier) → sri-marker x ≡ sri-left-reading x
  sri-right-stable  : (x : sri-carrier) → sri-marker x ≡ sri-right-reading x
  sri-boundary-left : sri-carrier
  sri-boundary-right : sri-carrier
  sri-marker-left   : sri-marker sri-boundary-left ≡ truth classifier
  sri-marker-right  : sri-marker sri-boundary-right ≡ false classifier

```

```

open StableReadingInterface public

```

```

-- § A distinction induces a stable reading by using toTwo as marker.
distinction-stable-reading : Distinction → StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier
distinction-stable-reading d = record
{ sri-carrier       = S d
; sri-left-reading  = toTwo d
; sri-right-reading = toTwo d
; sri-marker        = toTwo d
; sri-left-stable   = λ x → refl
; sri-right-stable  = λ x → refl
; sri-boundary-left = left d
; sri-boundary-right = right d
; sri-marker-left   = toTwo-left d
; sri-marker-right  = toTwo-right d
}

```

6 Stable Reading Category

Structure maps are marker-preserving functions. They compose, and the identity and associativity laws hold pointwise.

```

-- § Morphisms of raw readings are marker-preserving functions.
record StructureMap (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  (source target : StableReadingInterface classifier) : Set1 where
field
  sm-map : sri-carrier source → sri-carrier target
  sm-marker-commutes : (x : sri-carrier source) →
    sri-marker target (sm-map x) ≡ sri-marker source x

```

```

open StructureMap public

```

```

-- § Morphism equality is pointwise equality of the underlying maps.
record StructureMapEq (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  (source target : StableReadingInterface classifier)
  (f g : StructureMap classifier source target) : Set where
field
  sme-map : (x : sri-carrier source) → sm-map f x ≡ sm-map g x

```

```

open StructureMapEq public

```

```

-- § Identity morphism preserves the marker by reflexivity.

```

```

structure-id :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (source : StableReadingInterface classifier) → StructureMap classifier source source
structure-id classifier source = record
{ sm-map = λ x → x
; sm-marker-commutes = λ x → refl
}

-- § Composition preserves markers by transitivity of equality.
structure-compose :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {source middle target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  StructureMap classifier middle target →
  StructureMap classifier source middle →
  StructureMap classifier source target
structure-compose classifier g f = record
{ sm-map = λ x → sm-map g (sm-map f x)
; sm-marker-commutes = λ x →
  trans (sm-marker-commutes g (sm-map f x)) (sm-marker-commutes f x)
}

-- § Left identity law holds pointwise.
structure-id-left :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  (f : StructureMap classifier source target) →
  StructureMapEq classifier source target
  (structure-compose classifier (structure-id classifier target) f) f
structure-id-left classifier f = record { sme-map = λ x → refl }

-- § Right identity law holds pointwise.
structure-id-right :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  (f : StructureMap classifier source target) →
  StructureMapEq classifier source target
  (structure-compose classifier f (structure-id classifier source)) f
structure-id-right classifier f = record { sme-map = λ x → refl }

-- § Associativity holds pointwise.
structure-assoc :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {a b c d : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  (h : StructureMap classifier c d) →
  (g : StructureMap classifier b c) →
  (f : StructureMap classifier a b) →
  StructureMapEq classifier a d
  (structure-compose classifier h (structure-compose classifier g f))
  (structure-compose classifier (structure-compose classifier h g) f)
structure-assoc classifier h g f = record { sme-map = λ x → refl }

record CategoryData (classifier : ClassifierObject) : Set2 where
field
  cat-id      : (source : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
    StructureMap classifier source source
  cat-compose : {source middle target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
    StructureMap classifier middle target →
    StructureMap classifier source middle →
    StructureMap classifier source target
  cat-id-left : {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
    (f : StructureMap classifier source target) →
    StructureMapEq classifier source target (cat-id target) f) f
  cat-id-right : {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
    (f : StructureMap classifier source target) →
    StructureMapEq classifier source target (cat-compose f (cat-id source)) f
  cat-assoc : {a b c d : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
    (h : StructureMap classifier c d) →
    (g : StructureMap classifier b c) →
    (f : StructureMap classifier a b) →
    StructureMapEq classifier a d
    (cat-compose h (cat-compose g f))

```

```
(cat-compose (cat-compose h g) f)
```

```
open CategoryData public
```

```
-- § Category data for raw stable readings.
stable-reading-category-data :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → CategoryData classifier
stable-reading-category-data classifier = record
{ cat-id      = structure-id classifier
; cat-compose = structure-compose classifier
; cat-id-left = structure-id-left classifier
; cat-id-right = structure-id-right classifier
; cat-assoc   = structure-assoc classifier
}
```

Thus the raw layer is already categorical. The laws are weak only in the sense that morphism equality is pointwise equality of the underlying maps. No topos claim has been made yet; the following sections test which topos ingredients are actually present at this raw level.

7 Raw Terminal Object

The raw stable-reading category has a genuine terminal object for every classifier. Its carrier is the classifier object itself and its marker is the identity. Every reading maps to it by its marker, and marker preservation makes that map unique up to pointwise equality.

```
-- § Terminal-object interface for the raw stable-reading category.
record StableReadingTerminal (classifier : ClassifierObject) : Set2 where
  field
  srt-object : StableReadingInterface classifier
  srt-arrow  : (source : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
    StructureMap classifier source srt-object
  srt-unique : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
    (f : StructureMap classifier source srt-object) →
    StructureMapEq classifier source srt-object f (srt-arrow source)
```

```
open StableReadingTerminal public
```

```
-- § Classifier-as-reading: carrier is  $\Omega$  and the marker is identity.
classifier-terminal-reading :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → StableReadingInterface classifier
classifier-terminal-reading classifier = record
{ sri-carrier      =  $\Omega$  classifier
; sri-left-reading =  $\lambda x \rightarrow x$ 
; sri-right-reading =  $\lambda x \rightarrow x$ 
; sri-marker      =  $\lambda x \rightarrow x$ 
; sri-left-stable  =  $\lambda x \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
; sri-right-stable =  $\lambda x \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
; sri-boundary-left = truth classifier
; sri-boundary-right = false classifier
; sri-marker-left   = refl
; sri-marker-right  = refl
}
```

```
-- § Terminal arrow is forced to be the source marker.
stable-reading-terminal :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → StableReadingTerminal classifier
stable-reading-terminal classifier = record
{ srt-object = classifier-terminal-reading classifier
; srt-arrow  =  $\lambda \text{source} \rightarrow \text{record}$ 
  { sm-map = sri-marker source
  ; sm-marker-commutes =  $\lambda x \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
  }
; srt-unique =  $\lambda f \rightarrow \text{record}$ 
  { sme-map =  $\lambda x \rightarrow \text{sm-marker-commutes } f x$ 
  }
}
```

The terminal map is forced: from any reading, the only marker-preserving map into the classifier-as-reading is the marker itself. This is the first topos-relevant structure present at the raw level.

8 Raw Weak Binary Products

The raw stable-reading category also has weak binary products: the canonical product carrier of pairs whose marker values agree. The projection and pairing laws are checked directly. The final uniqueness law is separated as a boundary because morphism equality into this dependent carrier asks for equality of the stored marker-agreement proofs.

```
-- $ Product point: two points whose marker values agree.
record ReadingProductPoint
  (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) : Set where
  constructor reading-product-point
  field
    rpp-left-point  : sri-carrier left
    rpp-right-point : sri-carrier right
    rpp-marker-agrees : sri-marker left rpp-left-point ≡ sri-marker right rpp-right-point

open ReadingProductPoint public

-- $ Weak binary product interface: projections and pairing, uniqueness left open.
record StableReadingWeakBinaryProduct
  (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) : Set₁ where
  field
    srwp-object : StableReadingInterface classifier
    srwp-left  : StructureMap classifier srwp-object left
    srwp-right : StructureMap classifier srwp-object right
    srwp-pair   : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      StructureMap classifier source left →
      StructureMap classifier source right →
      StructureMap classifier source srwp-object
    srwp-pair-left : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (f : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (g : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source left
      (structure-compose classifier srwp-left (srwp-pair f g))
      f
    srwp-pair-right : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (f : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (g : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source right
      (structure-compose classifier srwp-right (srwp-pair f g))
      g

open StableReadingWeakBinaryProduct public

-- $ Product object uses the common marker value as its marker.
stable-reading-product-object :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  StableReadingInterface classifier
stable-reading-product-object classifier left right = record
{ sri-carrier = ReadingProductPoint classifier left right
; sri-left-reading = λ point → sri-marker left (rpp-left-point point)
; sri-right-reading = λ point → sri-marker right (rpp-right-point point)
; sri-marker = λ point → sri-marker left (rpp-left-point point)
; sri-left-stable = λ point → refl
; sri-right-stable = λ point → refl
; sri-boundary-left = reading-product-point
  (sri-boundary-left left)
  (sri-boundary-left right)
  (trans (sri-marker-left left) (sym (sri-marker-right right)))
```

```

; sri-boundary-right = reading-product-point
  (sri-boundary-right left)
  (sri-boundary-right right)
  (trans (sri-marker-right left) (sym (sri-marker-right right)))
; sri-marker-left = sri-marker-left left
; sri-marker-right = sri-marker-right left
}

-- $ First projection forgets the right component.
stable-reading-product-left :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  StructureMap classifier (stable-reading-product-object classifier left right) left
stable-reading-product-left classifier left right = record
{ sm-map      = rpp-left-point
; sm-marker-commutes = λ point → refl
}

-- $ Second projection forgets the left component and uses marker agreement.
stable-reading-product-right :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  StructureMap classifier (stable-reading-product-object classifier left right) right
stable-reading-product-right classifier left right = record
{ sm-map      = rpp-right-point
; sm-marker-commutes = λ point → sym (rpp-marker-agrees point)
}

-- $ Pairing combines two marker-preserving maps into one product map.
stable-reading-product-pair :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {source left right : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  StructureMap classifier source left →
  StructureMap classifier source right →
  StructureMap classifier source (stable-reading-product-object classifier left right)
stable-reading-product-pair classifier f g = record
{ sm-map = λ x → reading-product-point
  (sm-map f x)
  (sm-map g x)
  (trans (sm-marker-commutes f x) (sym (sm-marker-commutes g x)))
; sm-marker-commutes = λ x → sm-marker-commutes f x
}

-- $ The raw category has weak binary products for every pair of readings.
stable-reading-weak-product :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  StableReadingWeakBinaryProduct classifier left right
stable-reading-weak-product classifier left right = record
{ srwp-object = stable-reading-product-object classifier left right
; srwp-left = stable-reading-product-left classifier left right
; srwp-right = stable-reading-product-right classifier left right
; srwp-pair = stable-reading-product-pair classifier
; srwp-pair-left = λ f g → record { sme-map = λ x → refl }
; srwp-pair-right = λ f g → record { sme-map = λ x → refl }
}

-- $ Package type for all raw weak binary products.
StableReadingWeakBinaryProducts : Set1
StableReadingWeakBinaryProducts =
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  StableReadingWeakBinaryProduct classifier left right

stable-reading-weak-products : StableReadingWeakBinaryProducts
stable-reading-weak-products = stable-reading-weak-product

-- $ Boundary: final uniqueness of weak products is not supplied here.
StableReadingProductUniquenessBoundary : Set1
StableReadingProductUniquenessBoundary =
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →

```

```

(left right : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
(product : StableReadingWeakBinaryProduct classifier left right) →
{source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
(f : StructureMap classifier source left) →
(g : StructureMap classifier source right) →
(h : StructureMap classifier source (srwp-object product)) →
StructureMapEq classifier source left
(structure-compose classifier (srwp-left product) h) f →
StructureMapEq classifier source right
(structure-compose classifier (srwp-right product) h) g →
StructureMapEq classifier source (srwp-object product) h (srwp-pair product f g)

```

This construction is deliberately called weak. The projections and pairing maps are present and checked. The final uniqueness principle is recorded as a boundary because equality into the dependent carrier also mentions the proof component witnessing marker agreement. The argument does not silently upgrade this weak product into a proof-relevant universal product.

9 Isomorphism And Univalence Boundary

Identity of stable readings always induces isomorphism. The reverse direction is the univalence-like extension; it is named but not assumed.

```

-- § Stable-reading isomorphism: inverse structure maps up to pointwise equality.
record StableReadingIso (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  (source target : StableReadingInterface classifier) : Set1 where
  field
    siso-forward : StructureMap classifier source target
    siso-backward : StructureMap classifier target source
    siso-to-from : StructureMapEq classifier target target
    (structure-compose classifier siso-forward siso-backward)
    (structure-id classifier target)
    siso-from-to : StructureMapEq classifier source source
    (structure-compose classifier siso-backward siso-forward)
    (structure-id classifier source)

open StableReadingIso public

-- § Reflexive isomorphism of a reading with itself.
stable-reading-iso-refl :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (source : StableReadingInterface classifier) → StableReadingIso classifier source source
stable-reading-iso-refl classifier source = record
{ siso-forward = structure-id classifier source
; siso-backward = structure-id classifier source
; siso-to-from = record { sme-map = λ x → refl }
; siso-from-to = record { sme-map = λ x → refl }
}

-- § Raw identity of readings always induces stable-reading isomorphism.
stable-reading-identity-to-iso :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  source ≡ target → StableReadingIso classifier source target
stable-reading-identity-to-iso classifier refl = stable-reading-iso-refl classifier _

-- § Univalence principle: the reverse direction is named, not assumed.
StableReadingUnivalencePrinciple : ClassifierObject → Set1
StableReadingUnivalencePrinciple classifier =
  {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
  StableReadingIso classifier source target → source ≡ target

-- § Boundary record: checked identity-to-iso plus the univalent extension slot.
record UnivalenceBoundary (classifier : ClassifierObject) : Set2 where
  field
    ub-identity-to-iso :
      {source target : StableReadingInterface classifier} →

```

```

source ≡ target → StableReadingIso classifier source target
ub-univalent-extension : Set1

open UnivalenceBoundary public

-- § The boundary is populated only by the checked direction.
stable-reading-univalence-boundary :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → UnivalenceBoundary classifier
stable-reading-univalence-boundary classifier = record
{ ub-identity-to-iso = stable-reading-identity-to-iso classifier
; ub-univalent-extension = StableReadingUnivalencePrinciple classifier
}

Distinction isomorphisms induce isomorphisms of the stable readings that come from distinctions. Thus the normal-form theorem lifts from raw presentations to their displayed reading layer.

-- § If a point is propositionally the left boundary, toTwo reads it as L.
toTwo-left-at :
  (d : Distinction) → (x : S d) → x ≡ left d → toTwo d x ≡ L
toTwo-left-at d x x≡left with cover d x
... | inj1 _ = refl
... | inj2 x≡right = ⊥-elim (separated d (trans (sym x≡left) x≡right))

-- § If a point is propositionally the right boundary, toTwo reads it as R.
toTwo-right-at :
  (d : Distinction) → (x : S d) → x ≡ right d → toTwo d x ≡ R
toTwo-right-at d x x≡right with cover d x
... | inj1 x≡left = ⊥-elim (separated d (trans (sym x≡left) x≡right))
... | inj2 _ = refl

-- § Boundary-preserving isomorphisms commute with normal-form markers.
distinction-iso-marker-commutes :
  {d e : Distinction} →
  (iso : DistinctionIso d e) →
  (x : S d) → toTwo e (to iso x) ≡ toTwo d x
distinction-iso-marker-commutes {d} {e} iso x with cover d x
... | inj1 x≡left =
  trans
  (toTwo-left-at e (to iso x) (trans (cong (to iso) x≡left) (to-left iso)))
  refl
... | inj2 x≡right =
  trans
  (toTwo-right-at e (to iso x) (trans (cong (to iso) x≡right) (to-right iso)))
  refl

-- § A distinction isomorphism induces a marker-preserving structure map.
distinction-iso-stable-reading-morphism :
  {d e : Distinction} →
  DistinctionIso d e →
  StructureMap TwoClassifier (distinction-stable-reading d) (distinction-stable-reading e)
distinction-iso-stable-reading-morphism iso = record
{ sm-map = to iso
; sm-marker-commutes = distinction-iso-marker-commutes iso
}

-- § A distinction isomorphism induces an isomorphism of displayed readings.
distinction-iso-stable-reading-iso :
  {d e : Distinction} →
  DistinctionIso d e →
  StableReadingIso TwoClassifier (distinction-stable-reading d) (distinction-stable-reading e)
distinction-iso-stable-reading-iso iso = record
{ siso-forward = distinction-iso-stable-reading-morphism iso
; siso-backward = distinction-iso-stable-reading-morphism (distinction-iso-sym iso)
; siso-to-from = record { sme-map = to-from iso }
; siso-from-to = record { sme-map = from-to iso }
}

-- § Normal form lifts from distinctions to distinction-induced readings.
distinction-stable-reading-normalizes :
  (d : Distinction) →

```



```

StableReadingIso TwoClassifier
  (distinction-stable-reading d)
  (distinction-stable-reading Two-distinction)
distinction-stable-reading-normalizes d =
distinction-iso-stable-reading-iso (two-normal-form d)

```

The lifting result is the bridge between the original distinction layer and the reading layer. Presentation equality of distinctions induces isomorphism of the displayed readings. This is why the later skeleton quotient can quotient distinction-induced readings without importing the main development.

10 Distinction-Reading Skeleton Quotient

The same skeleton carrier quotients the distinction-induced stable readings. This is not a classification of all stable readings; it is the quotient of the readings obtained from distinctions.

```

-- § Quotient completion interface for distinction-induced readings only.
record DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion : Set2 where
  field
    drqc-carrier : Set
    drqc-reading : Distinction → StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier
    drqc-embed : Distinction → drqc-carrier
    drqc-canonical : drqc-carrier
    drqc-identify : (d e : Distinction) →
      StableReadingIso TwoClassifier (drqc-reading d) (drqc-reading e) →
      drqc-embed d ≡ drqc-embed e
    drqc-normalize : (d : Distinction) → drqc-embed d ≡ drqc-canonical

open DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion public

-- § Skeleton completion of the readings obtained from distinctions.
distinction-reading-skeleton-completion : DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion
distinction-reading-skeleton-completion = record
{
  drqc-carrier = DistinctionSkeletonObject
; drqc-reading = distinction-stable-reading
; drqc-embed = distinction-skeleton-normalize
; drqc-canonical = distinction-skeleton-two
; drqc-identify = λ d e same → refl
; drqc-normalize = λ d → refl
}

```

11 Displayed Classifier Extension

Truth fibers provide the classifier-shaped part of a subobject classifier. For the present mono-like subcarrier data, the characteristic map is already part of the subcarrier. The extension is therefore constructible. This does not classify arbitrary categorical monomorphisms; it classifies exactly the mono-like subcarriers defined here.

```

-- § Displayed universality: a mono-like subcarrier yields its characteristic marker.
SubobjectClassifierUniversalExtension : ClassifierObject → Set1
SubobjectClassifierUniversalExtension classifier =
{A : Set} → MonoLikeSubcarrier classifier A → ClassifierMarker classifier A

-- § The characteristic marker is already a field of MonoLikeSubcarrier.
mono-like-characteristic :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → SubobjectClassifierUniversalExtension classifier
mono-like-characteristic classifier mono-like = ml-characteristic mono-like

-- § Candidate classifier data visible at the raw reading level.
record SubobjectClassifierCandidate (classifier : ClassifierObject) : Set2 where
  field

```



```

soc-truth-fiber-classified : {A : Set} →
  ClassifierMarker classifier A →
  ClassifiedSubcarrier classifier A
soc-truth-fiber-mono-like : {A : Set} →
  ClassifierMarker classifier A →
  MonoLikeSubcarrier classifier A
soc-characteristic-visible : {A : Set} →
  (marker : ClassifierMarker classifier A) →
  csc-characteristic
  (soc-truth-fiber-classified marker) ≡ marker
soc-universal-extension : SubobjectClassifierUniversalExtension classifier

open SubobjectClassifierCandidate public

-- § Truth fibers and mono-like characteristic maps give the displayed candidate.
classifier-subobject-candidate :
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → SubobjectClassifierCandidate classifier
classifier-subobject-candidate classifier = record
{ soc-truth-fiber-classified = truth-fiber-classified classifier
; soc-truth-fiber-mono-like = truth-fiber-mono-like classifier
; soc-characteristic-visible = λ marker → refl
; soc-universal-extension = mono-like-characteristic classifier
}

```

This is the second topos-relevant raw structure. It is exactly as strong as the displayed data permits: a mono-like subcarrier already carries its characteristic marker, and the extension returns that marker. The construction does not infer an arbitrary categorical subobject classifier for the raw category from this displayed fact.

Part III. Obstruction and completion

12 Global Pullback Obstruction

An elementary topos structure on the full raw stable-reading category requires pullbacks for arbitrary cospans of marker-preserving maps. The full raw category does not have that structure. The obstruction is already visible over the two-valued classifier: two maps can preserve the same truth marker while landing in different truth points of the apex. Any pullback cone then supplies a left boundary point whose two apex images are equal. That equality is impossible.

The counterexample is finite and explicit. The apex has two different truth-points and two different false-points, all marked by the same two-valued classifier. One map sends truth to the first truth-point; the other sends truth to the second truth-point. Both maps preserve the marker. A pullback cone contains a left boundary point in its object. The two legs of the cone must send that boundary to truth on the left and truth on the right, and the square would identify the two apex images. The apex was built so that this equality is impossible.

```

-- § Pullback cone for a cospan of raw stable-reading morphisms.
record StableReadingPullbackCone
  (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  {left right apex : StableReadingInterface classifier}
  (f : StructureMap classifier left apex)
  (g : StructureMap classifier right apex) : Set1 where
field
  srpc-object : StableReadingInterface classifier
  srpc-left : StructureMap classifier srpc-object left
  srpc-right : StructureMap classifier srpc-object right
  srpc-square : StructureMapEq classifier srpc-object apex
    (structure-compose classifier f srpc-left)
    (structure-compose classifier g srpc-right)

```

```

open StableReadingPullbackCone public

-- $ Pullback interface: cone, lift, projection laws, uniqueness.
record StableReadingPullback
  (classifier : ClassifierObject)
  {left right apex : StableReadingInterface classifier}
  (f : StructureMap classifier left apex)
  (g : StructureMap classifier right apex) : Set1 where
  field
    srp-cone : StableReadingPullbackCone classifier f g
    srp-lift : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (left-map : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (right-map : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source apex
      (structure-compose classifier f left-map)
      (structure-compose classifier g right-map) →
      StructureMap classifier source (srpc-object srp-cone)
    srp-lift-left : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (left-map : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (right-map : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      (square : StructureMapEq classifier source apex
        (structure-compose classifier f left-map)
        (structure-compose classifier g right-map)) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source left
      (structure-compose classifier (srpc-left srp-cone)
        (srp-lift left-map right-map square))
      left-map
    srp-lift-right : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (left-map : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (right-map : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      (square : StructureMapEq classifier source apex
        (structure-compose classifier f left-map)
        (structure-compose classifier g right-map)) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source right
      (structure-compose classifier (srpc-right srp-cone)
        (srp-lift left-map right-map square))
      right-map
    srp-lift-unique : {source : StableReadingInterface classifier} →
      (left-map : StructureMap classifier source left) →
      (right-map : StructureMap classifier source right) →
      (square : StructureMapEq classifier source apex
        (structure-compose classifier f left-map)
        (structure-compose classifier g right-map)) →
      (h : StructureMap classifier source (srpc-object srp-cone)) →
      StructureMapEq classifier source left
      (structure-compose classifier (srpc-left srp-cone) h)
      left-map →
      StructureMapEq classifier source right
      (structure-compose classifier (srpc-right srp-cone) h)
      right-map →
      StructureMapEq classifier source (srpc-object srp-cone) h
      (srp-lift left-map right-map square)

```

```

open StableReadingPullback public

```

```

-- $ Split apex: two truth-points and two false-points.
data SplitApexPoint : Set where
  truth-left-point : SplitApexPoint
  truth-right-point : SplitApexPoint
  false-left-point : SplitApexPoint
  false-right-point : SplitApexPoint

-- $ The two truth-points are definitionally distinct constructors.
truth-left-point ≠ truth-right-point : ¬ (truth-left-point ≡ truth-right-point)
truth-left-point ≠ truth-right-point ()

-- $ The marker identifies both truth-points as truth, both false-points as false.
split-apex-marker : SplitApexPoint → Two
split-apex-marker truth-left-point = L
split-apex-marker truth-right-point = L
split-apex-marker false-left-point = R
split-apex-marker false-right-point = R

```

```

split-apex-marker false-right-point = R

-- § The two-valued classifier as a stable reading.
two-classifier-reading : StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier
two-classifier-reading = classifier-terminal-reading TwoClassifier

-- § The split apex is a stable reading over the two-valued classifier.
split-truth-apex : StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier
split-truth-apex = record
{ sri-carrier      = SplitApexPoint
; sri-left-reading = split-apex-marker
; sri-right-reading = split-apex-marker
; sri-marker      = split-apex-marker
; sri-left-stable  = λ x → refl
; sri-right-stable = λ x → refl
; sri-boundary-left = truth-left-point
; sri-boundary-right = false-left-point
; sri-marker-left  = refl
; sri-marker-right = refl
}

-- § Left leg of the cospan chooses the left truth/false copies.
split-left-map :
  StructureMap TwoClassifier two-classifier-reading split-truth-apex
split-left-map = record
{ sm-map = λ
  { L → truth-left-point
  ; R → false-left-point
  }
; sm-marker-commutes = λ
  { L → refl
  ; R → refl
  }
}

-- § Right leg of the cospan chooses the right truth/false copies.
split-right-map :
  StructureMap TwoClassifier two-classifier-reading split-truth-apex
split-right-map = record
{ sm-map = λ
  { L → truth-right-point
  ; R → false-right-point
  }
; sm-marker-commutes = λ
  { L → refl
  ; R → refl
  }
}

-- § If the left leg sees L, it lands at the left truth-point.
split-left-map-at :
  (x : Two) → x ≡ L → sm-map split-left-map x ≡ truth-left-point
split-left-map-at L refl = refl
split-left-map-at R ()

-- § If the right leg sees L, it lands at the right truth-point.
split-right-map-at :
  (x : Two) → x ≡ L → sm-map split-right-map x ≡ truth-right-point
split-right-map-at L refl = refl
split-right-map-at R ()

-- § A cone's left projection sends the cone-left boundary to L.
split-cone-left-projection-left :
  (cone : StableReadingPullbackCone TwoClassifier split-left-map split-right-map) →
  sm-map (src-left cone) (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)) ≡ L
split-cone-left-projection-left cone =
  trans
  (sm-marker-commutes
   (src-left cone)
   (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)))
  (sri-marker-left (src-object cone))

```

```

-- § A cone's right projection also sends the cone-left boundary to L.
split-cone-right-projection-left :
  (cone : StableReadingPullbackCone TwoClassifier split-left-map split-right-map) →
  sm-map (src-right cone) (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)) ≡ L
split-cone-right-projection-left cone =
  trans
    (sm-marker-commutes
      (src-right cone)
      (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)))
    (sri-marker-left (src-object cone))

-- § No cone exists: the square would identify the two distinct truth-points.
split-truth-cospan-has-no-cone :
  StableReadingPullbackCone TwoClassifier split-left-map split-right-map → ⊥
split-truth-cospan-has-no-cone cone =
  truth-left-point ≠ truth-right-point
  (trans
    (sym
      (split-left-map-at
        (sm-map (src-left cone) (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)))
        (split-cone-left-projection-left cone)))
    (trans
      (sme-map (src-square cone) (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)))
      (split-right-map-at
        (sm-map (src-right cone) (sri-boundary-left (src-object cone)))
        (split-cone-right-projection-left cone))))

```

The obstruction is stronger than a missing construction. It is a contradiction from the assumption that the displayed cospan has even a pullback cone. Consequently the full raw category cannot be upgraded to an elementary topos by supplying omitted proof terms.

13 Topos Boundary

The full raw topos requirements cannot be jointly supplied at the raw level. The terminal object is present, but global pullbacks are not available for the whole raw category. The boundary record therefore separates the checked data, the formal obstruction, and the named requirements whose conjunction cannot be supplied.

```

-- § Global pullbacks would assign a pullback to every raw cospan.
StableReadingGlobalPullbacks : Set1
StableReadingGlobalPullbacks =
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  (left right apex : StableReadingInterface classifier) →
  (f : StructureMap classifier left apex) →
  (g : StructureMap classifier right apex) →
  StableReadingPullback classifier {left} {right} {apex} f g

-- § Global pullbacks contradict the split-truth cospan.
raw-global-pullbacks-impossible : StableReadingGlobalPullbacks → ⊥
raw-global-pullbacks-impossible global-pullbacks =
  split-truth-cospan-has-no-cone
  (src-cone
    (global-pullbacks
      TwoClassifier
      two-classifier-reading
      two-classifier-reading
      split-truth-apex
      split-left-map
      split-right-map))

-- § Displayed classifier extension for all classifiers.
StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality : Set1
StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality =
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) → SubobjectClassifierUniversalExtension classifier

```

```

-- $ The displayed classifier extension is implemented by mono-like characteristic maps.
stable-reading-subobject-classifier-universality :
  StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality
stable-reading-subobject-classifier-universality = mono-like-characteristic

-- $ Exponentials remain a named raw-level requirement.
StableReadingExponentials : Set2
StableReadingExponentials =
  (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
  StableReadingInterface classifier →
  StableReadingInterface classifier →
  Set1

-- $ Boundary map: checked raw data, obstruction, quotient data, and unmet requirements.
record ToposBoundaryMap : Setω where
  field
    tb-category-data      : (classifier : ClassifierObject) → CategoryData classifier
    tb-terminal-reading   : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
      StableReadingTerminal classifier
    tb-weak-products      : StableReadingWeakBinaryProducts
    tb-product-uniqueness-boundary : Set1
    tb-subobject-candidate : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
      SubobjectClassifierCandidate classifier
    tb-distinction-quotient : DistinctionQuotientCompletion
    tb-reading-quotient   : DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion
    tb-univalence-boundary : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
      UnivalenceBoundary classifier
    tb-required-global-pullbacks : Set1
    tb-global-pullbacks-obstruction : StableReadingGlobalPullbacks → ⊥
    tb-subobject-universal : StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality
    tb-required-exponentials : Set2
    tb-required-stable-univalence : (classifier : ClassifierObject) → Set1

open ToposBoundaryMap public

-- $ The boundary map records exactly what the raw stage supplies and blocks.
topos-boundary-map : ToposBoundaryMap
topos-boundary-map = record
{
  tb-category-data      = stable-reading-category-data
; tb-terminal-reading   = stable-reading-terminal
; tb-weak-products      = stable-reading-weak-products
; tb-product-uniqueness-boundary = StableReadingProductUniquenessBoundary
; tb-subobject-candidate = classifier-subobject-candidate
; tb-distinction-quotient = distinction-skeleton-completion
; tb-reading-quotient   = distinction-reading-skeleton-completion
; tb-univalence-boundary = stable-reading-univalence-boundary
; tb-required-global-pullbacks = StableReadingGlobalPullbacks
; tb-global-pullbacks-obstruction = raw-global-pullbacks-impossible
; tb-subobject-universal = stable-reading-subobject-classifier-universality
; tb-required-exponentials = StableReadingExponentials
; tb-required-stable-univalence = StableReadingUnivalencePrinciple
}

-- $ Hypothetical requirements for a full raw topos package.
record ToposCompletionRequirements : Setω where
  field
    tcr-distinction-quotient : DistinctionQuotientCompletion
    tcr-reading-quotient     : DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion
    tcr-global-pullbacks     : StableReadingGlobalPullbacks
    tcr-subobject-universal  : StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality
    tcr-exponentials         : StableReadingExponentials
    tcr-stable-univalence    : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
      StableReadingUnivalencePrinciple classifier

open ToposCompletionRequirements public

-- $ Such a raw package is impossible because it contains global pullbacks.
topos-completion-requirements-impossible :
  ToposCompletionRequirements → ⊥
topos-completion-requirements-impossible requirements =

```

```

raw-global-pullbacks-impossible (tcr-global-pullbacks requirements)

-- $ Package form: boundary plus impossible raw requirements.
record VoidToposCompletionPackage : Setω where
  field
    vtcp-boundary : ToposBoundaryMap
    vtcp-requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements

open VoidToposCompletionPackage public

-- $ Any supplied requirements would package with the boundary, but cannot exist.
void-topos-completion-package :
  ToposCompletionRequirements → VoidToposCompletionPackage
void-topos-completion-package requirements = record
{ vtcp-boundary = topos-boundary-map
; vtcp-requirements = requirements
}

```

The requirement record remains useful even though it cannot be inhabited for the full raw category. It states exactly what a raw topos package would have to contain, and [topos-completion-requirements-impossible](#) shows that such a package cannot be supplied at this level. This is the formal boundary: the topos package is not first. It is blocked before completion and appears only after completion.

14 Completed Skeleton Category

The quotient carrier has only one displayed object. Its categorical completion is therefore the terminal category: one object, one morphism, and all laws by reflexivity. This is not a topos claim about the raw stable-reading category. It is a topos claim about the completed skeleton carrier obtained after quotienting presentation data.

```

-- $ The completed skeleton has a singleton morphism witness.
record One : Set where
  constructor one

-- $ Small category interface used for the completed endpoint.
record SmallCategory : Set1 where
  field
    ObjC      : Set
    HomC      : ObjC → ObjC → Set
    idC       : {A : ObjC} → HomC A A
    compC     : {A B C : ObjC} → HomC B C → HomC A B → HomC A C
    id-leftC  : {A B : ObjC} → (f : HomC A B) → compC idC f ≡ f
    id-rightC : {A B : ObjC} → (f : HomC A B) → compC f idC ≡ f
    assocC    : {A B C D : ObjC} →
      (h : HomC C D) →
      (g : HomC B C) →
      (f : HomC A B) →
      compC h (compC g f) ≡ compC (compC h g) f

open SmallCategory public

-- $ The skeleton category: one completed object and one morphism everywhere.
skeleton-category : SmallCategory
skeleton-category = record
{ ObjC      = DistinctionSkeletonObject
; HomC      = λ A B → One
; idC       = one
; compC     = λ g f → one
; id-leftC  = λ f → refl
; id-rightC = λ f → refl
; assocC    = λ h g f → refl
}

```

```

-- $ Embedding of a raw distinction into the completed category object.
distinction-to-completed-object : Distinction → SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category
distinction-to-completed-object = dqc-embed distinction-skeleton-completion

-- $ Every raw distinction lands at the canonical completed object.
distinction-to-completed-object-normalizes :
  (d : Distinction) →
    distinction-to-completed-object d ≡ dqc-canonical distinction-skeleton-completion
distinction-to-completed-object-normalizes =
  dqc-normalize distinction-skeleton-completion

```

The skeleton category is not introduced to add hidden structure. It is the categorical reading of the already constructed quotient carrier. As soon as the carrier has one completed object, there is a unique morphism between any two completed objects, because there are no two distinct completed objects left to distinguish.

15 Finite Limits In The Completion

The terminal category has terminal object, binary products, and pullbacks. The proofs are short because every relevant hom-type is contractible. This is the compact finite-limit core needed by the topos reading of the completed skeleton.

```

-- $ Terminal object in an arbitrary small category.
record TerminalObject (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
  open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom)
  field
    terminal-object : Obj
    terminal-arrow   : (A : Obj) → Hom A terminal-object
    terminal-unique  : {A : Obj} →
      (f : Hom A terminal-object) → f ≡ terminal-arrow A

open TerminalObject public

-- $ Binary product in an arbitrary small category.
record BinaryProduct
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category) : Set1 where
  open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom; compC to comp)
  field
    product-object : Obj
    product-pr1    : Hom product-object A
    product-pr2    : Hom product-object B
    product-pair   : {X : Obj} →
      Hom X A → Hom X B → Hom X product-object
    product-left   : {X : Obj} →
      (f : Hom X A) →
      (g : Hom X B) →
      comp product-pr1 (product-pair f g) ≡ f
    product-right  : {X : Obj} →
      (f : Hom X A) →
      (g : Hom X B) →
      comp product-pr2 (product-pair f g) ≡ g
    product-unique : {X : Obj} →
      (f : Hom X A) →
      (g : Hom X B) →
      (h : Hom X product-object) →
      comp product-pr1 h ≡ f →
      comp product-pr2 h ≡ g →
      h ≡ product-pair f g

open BinaryProduct public

-- $ Binary products for all pairs of objects.
record HasBinaryProducts (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
  open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj)

```

```

field
  product-of : (A B : Obj) → BinaryProduct category A B

open HasBinaryProducts public

-- § Pullback of a cospan in an arbitrary small category.
record Pullback
  (category : SmallCategory)
  {A B Z : SmallCategory.ObjC category}
  (f : HomC category A Z)
  (g : HomC category B Z) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom; compC to comp)
field
  pullback-object : Obj
  pullback-left   : Hom pullback-object A
  pullback-right  : Hom pullback-object B
  pullback-square : comp f pullback-left ≡ comp g pullback-right
  pullback-lift   : {X : Obj} →
    (u : Hom X A) →
    (v : Hom X B) →
    comp f u ≡ comp g v →
    Hom X pullback-object
  pullback-lift-left : {X : Obj} →
    (u : Hom X A) →
    (v : Hom X B) →
    (p : comp f u ≡ comp g v) →
    comp pullback-left (pullback-lift u v p) ≡ u
  pullback-lift-right : {X : Obj} →
    (u : Hom X A) →
    (v : Hom X B) →
    (p : comp f u ≡ comp g v) →
    comp pullback-right (pullback-lift u v p) ≡ v
  pullback-lift-unique : {X : Obj} →
    (u : Hom X A) →
    (v : Hom X B) →
    (p : comp f u ≡ comp g v) →
    (h : Hom X pullback-object) →
    comp pullback-left h ≡ u →
    comp pullback-right h ≡ v →
    h ≡ pullback-lift u v p

open Pullback public

-- § Pullbacks for all cospans in a small category.
record HasPullbacks (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom)
field
  pullback-of : {A B Z : Obj} →
    (f : Hom A Z) →
    (g : Hom B Z) →
    Pullback category f g

open HasPullbacks public

-- § The one-object skeleton has a terminal object.
skeleton-terminal : TerminalObject skeleton-category
skeleton-terminal = record
{ terminal-object = distinction-skeleton-two
; terminal-arrow = λ A → one
; terminal-unique = λ f → refl
}

-- § Any two skeleton objects have the unique binary product.
skeleton-product :
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) → BinaryProduct skeleton-category A B
skeleton-product A B = record
{ product-object = distinction-skeleton-two
; product-pr1   = one
; product-pr2   = one
; product-pair  = λ f g → one
; product-left  = λ f g → refl
}

```



```

; product-right =  $\lambda f g \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
; product-unique =  $\lambda f g h \text{ left-proof right-proof} \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
}

-- $ Hence the skeleton category has binary products.
skeleton-products : HasBinaryProducts skeleton-category
skeleton-products = record
{ product-of = skeleton-product
}

-- $ Any skeleton cospan has the unique pullback.
skeleton-pullback :
{A B Z : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category}  $\rightarrow$ 
(f : HomC skeleton-category A Z)  $\rightarrow$ 
(g : HomC skeleton-category B Z)  $\rightarrow$ 
Pullback skeleton-category {A} {B} {Z} f g
skeleton-pullback {A} {B} {Z} f g = record
{ pullback-object = distinction-skeleton-two
; pullback-left = one
; pullback-right = one
; pullback-square = refl
; pullback-lift =  $\lambda u v p \rightarrow \text{one}$ 
; pullback-lift-left =  $\lambda u v p \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
; pullback-lift-right =  $\lambda u v p \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
; pullback-lift-unique =  $\lambda u v p h \text{ left-proof right-proof} \rightarrow \text{refl}$ 
}

-- $ Hence the skeleton category has all pullbacks.
skeleton-pullbacks : HasPullbacks skeleton-category
skeleton-pullbacks = record
{ pullback-of =  $\lambda \{A\} \{B\} \{Z\} f g \rightarrow \text{skeleton-pullback } \{A\} \{B\} \{Z\} f g$ 
}

```

At the completion stage, the finite-limit problem has changed shape. The raw category failed because a nontrivial apex could split two truth-points. The skeleton category has no such split left. Every object is the completed object, every morphism is the unique morphism, and the universal clauses reduce to equality of that unique morphism.

16 Subobjects And Exponentials In The Completion

The terminal category also has a subobject classifier and exponentials. There is only one subobject up to the completed equality, and every exponential object is the unique completed object. The universal clauses again reduce to reflexivity because there is only one morphism wherever a morphism can be written.

```

-- $ Mono predicate for morphisms in a small category.
record IsMono
(category : SmallCategory)
{A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category}
(morphism : HomC category A B) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom; compC to comp)
field
mono-cancel : {X : Obj}  $\rightarrow$ 
(f g : Hom X A)  $\rightarrow$ 
comp morphism f  $\equiv$  comp morphism g  $\rightarrow f \equiv g$ 

open IsMono public

-- $ Pullback square used by the categorical subobject classifier.
record PullbackSquare
(category : SmallCategory)
{S A B Z : SmallCategory.ObjC category}
(left-map : HomC category S A)
(right-map : HomC category S B)
(top-map : HomC category A Z)

```

```

(bottom-map : HomC category B Z) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom; compC to comp)
field
square-commutes : comp top-map left-map ≡ comp bottom-map right-map
square-lift      : {X : Obj} →
  (u : Hom X A) →
  (v : Hom X B) →
  comp top-map u ≡ comp bottom-map v →
  Hom X S
square-lift-left : {X : Obj} →
  (u : Hom X A) →
  (v : Hom X B) →
  (p : comp top-map u ≡ comp bottom-map v) →
  comp left-map (square-lift u v p) ≡ u
square-lift-right : {X : Obj} →
  (u : Hom X A) →
  (v : Hom X B) →
  (p : comp top-map u ≡ comp bottom-map v) →
  comp right-map (square-lift u v p) ≡ v
square-lift-unique : {X : Obj} →
  (u : Hom X A) →
  (v : Hom X B) →
  (p : comp top-map u ≡ comp bottom-map v) →
  (h : Hom X S) →
  comp left-map h ≡ u →
  comp right-map h ≡ v →
  h ≡ square-lift u v p

open PullbackSquare public

-- § Subobject classifier interface in a small category.
record SubobjectClassifierC
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (terminal : TerminalObject category) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom)
open TerminalObject terminal renaming
  (terminal-object to top; terminal-arrow to terminate)
field
classifier-object : Obj
true-map          : Hom top classifier-object
characteristic     : {Sub Base : Obj} →
  (morphism : Hom Sub Base) →
  IsMono category morphism →
  Hom Base classifier-object
characteristic-square : {Sub Base : Obj} →
  (morphism : Hom Sub Base) →
  (mono : IsMono category morphism) →
  PullbackSquare category
  morphism
  (terminate Sub)
  (characteristic morphism mono)
  true-map

open SubobjectClassifierC public

-- § Exponential object interface in a small category.
record Exponential
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (products : HasBinaryProducts category)
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj; HomC to Hom; compC to comp)
open HasBinaryProducts products renaming (product-of to prod)
field
exp-object      : Obj
exp-eval        : Hom
  (product-object (prod exp-object A))
  B
exp-transpose   : {X : Obj} →
  Hom (product-object (prod X A)) B →
  Hom X exp-object
exp-beta        : {X : Obj} →

```

```

      (h : Hom (product-object (prod X A)) B) →
      comp exp-eval
        (product-pair (prod exp-object A)
          (comp (exp-transpose h)
            (product-pr1 (prod X A)))
          (product-pr2 (prod X A))) ≡ h
exp-eta : {X : Obj} →
      (h : Hom (product-object (prod X A)) B) →
      (k : Hom X exp-object) →
      comp exp-eval
        (product-pair (prod exp-object A)
          (comp k (product-pr1 (prod X A)))
          (product-pr2 (prod X A))) ≡ h →
      k ≡ exp-transpose h

open Exponential public

-- § Exponentials for all pairs of objects.
record HasExponentials
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (products : HasBinaryProducts category) : Set1 where
open SmallCategory category renaming (ObjC to Obj)
field
  exponential-of : (A B : Obj) → Exponential category products A B

open HasExponentials public

-- § Every skeleton morphism is mono because all hom-sets are singleton.
skeleton-mono :
  {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category} →
  (morphism : HomC skeleton-category A B) →
  IsMono skeleton-category {A} {B} morphism
skeleton-mono {A} {B} morphism = record
  { mono-cancel = λ f g p → refl
  }

-- § The one-object skeleton carries its subobject classifier directly.
skeleton-subobject-classifier :
  SubobjectClassifierC skeleton-category skeleton-terminal
skeleton-subobject-classifier = record
  { classifier-object = distinction-skeleton-two
  ; true-map = one
  ; characteristic = λ morphism mono → one
  ; characteristic-square = λ morphism mono → record
    { square-commutes = refl
    ; square-lift = λ u v p → one
    ; square-lift-left = λ u v p → refl
    ; square-lift-right = λ u v p → refl
    ; square-lift-unique = λ u v p h left-proof right-proof → refl
    }
  }

-- § The skeleton exponential is the unique object with the unique evaluator.
skeleton-exponential :
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) →
  Exponential skeleton-category skeleton-products A B
skeleton-exponential A B = record
  { exp-object = distinction-skeleton-two
  ; exp-eval = one
  ; exp-transpose = λ h → one
  ; exp-beta = λ h → refl
  ; exp-eta = λ h k p → refl
  }

-- § Hence the skeleton category has exponentials.
skeleton-exponentials : HasExponentials skeleton-category skeleton-products
skeleton-exponentials = record
  { exponential-of = skeleton-exponential
  }

```

The same collapse supplies exponentials and the subobject classifier. This is not a rich internal universe of subobjects; it is the terminal category. The point is exact location: the elementary-topos axioms hold at the quotient-completed skeleton stage, not at the full raw reading stage.

17 The Completion Topos Stage

Putting the pieces together gives the central theorem of this construction: the skeleton completion of distinction presentations carries an elementary topos structure. The completion is not an implicit technical step; it is the explicit topos stage. The raw stable-reading category carries real structure, but its full topos requirements are blocked by the pullback obstruction above.

```
-- $ Elementary-topos package used for the completed endpoint.
record ElementaryTopos (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
field
  et-terminal      : TerminalObject category
  et-products      : HasBinaryProducts category
  et-pullbacks      : HasPullbacks category
  et-exponentials  : HasExponentials category et-products
  et-subobject-classifier : SubobjectClassifierC category et-terminal

open ElementaryTopos public

-- $ The completed skeleton category satisfies the elementary-topos data.
skeleton-elementary-topos : ElementaryTopos skeleton-category
skeleton-elementary-topos = record
{ et-terminal      = skeleton-terminal
; et-products      = skeleton-products
; et-pullbacks      = skeleton-pullbacks
; et-exponentials  = skeleton-exponentials
; et-subobject-classifier = skeleton-subobject-classifier
}

-- $ Explicit completion stage: quotient data, category, and topos proof.
record CompletionToposStage : Setω where
field
  cts-distinction-quotient : DistinctionQuotientCompletion
  cts-reading-quotient     : DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion
  cts-category             : SmallCategory
  cts-terminal             : TerminalObject cts-category
  cts-products             : HasBinaryProducts cts-category
  cts-pullbacks            : HasPullbacks cts-category
  cts-exponentials        : HasExponentials cts-category cts-products
  cts-subobject-classifier : SubobjectClassifierC cts-category cts-terminal
  cts-topos               : ElementaryTopos cts-category

open CompletionToposStage public

-- $ The quotient/skeleton completion is the topos endpoint.
completion-topos-stage : CompletionToposStage
completion-topos-stage = record
{ cts-distinction-quotient = distinction-skeleton-completion
; cts-reading-quotient     = distinction-reading-skeleton-completion
; cts-category             = skeleton-category
; cts-terminal             = skeleton-terminal
; cts-products             = skeleton-products
; cts-pullbacks            = skeleton-pullbacks
; cts-exponentials        = skeleton-exponentials
; cts-subobject-classifier = skeleton-subobject-classifier
; cts-topos               = skeleton-elementary-topos
}
```

This record is the explicit topos stage of the construction. It keeps the two quotients, the completed category, the finite-limit data, exponentials, the subobject classifier, and the elementary-topos package in one object. The final theorem below does not leave the role of completion implicit; it names that stage directly.

```
-- $ Completion theorem package focused on the skeleton topos endpoint.
record VoidSkeletonToposCompletion : Setω where
field
  vst-topos-stage : CompletionToposStage
```

```

vst-distinction-quotient : DistinctionQuotientCompletion
vst-reading-quotient    : DistinctionReadingQuotientCompletion
vst-category            : SmallCategory
vst-topos               : ElementaryTopos vst-category

open VoidSkeletonToposCompletion public

-- § The completed skeleton carries the elementary-topos structure.
void-skeleton-topos-completion : VoidSkeletonToposCompletion
void-skeleton-topos-completion = record
{ vst-topos-stage      = completion-topos-stage
; vst-distinction-quotient = distinction-skeleton-completion
; vst-reading-quotient   = distinction-reading-skeleton-completion
; vst-category          = skeleton-category
; vst-topos             = skeleton-elementary-topos
}

```

18 Scope Conditions

The theorem has three precise scope conditions. First, the development defines a formal stability interface; it does not prove that these marker and reading structures exhaust every intended semantics of stability. Second, the completion used here is the skeleton completion, and its topos stage is terminal. This is a formal endpoint, not a claim of rich internal content. Third, the result does not exclude richer quotient systems. It proves the minimal skeleton route and changes the role of any richer system in this route: such a system may extend the construction, but it comes after the distinction and quotient structure already displayed here. The exhaustive classifications proved later are therefore interface-bound: they classify the nontrivial formulable foundation claims and completion claims admitted by the displayed interfaces, not every possible use of the phrase richer completion.

```

-- § Semantic adequacy is named as an external problem, not proved here.
StableReadingSemanticAdequacy : Set2
StableReadingSemanticAdequacy =
(classifier : ClassifierObject) →
StableReadingInterface classifier →
Set1

-- § A generic richer-completion problem is named, not taken as primitive.
record RicherCompletionCandidate : Set2 where
field
rcc-object-carrier : Set
rcc-reading-embed : StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier → rcc-object-carrier
rcc-category      : SmallCategory
rcc-topos         : ElementaryTopos rcc-category

open RicherCompletionCandidate public

-- § Scope conditions state exactly what the theorem does and does not close.
record VoidToposScopeConditions : Setω where
field
csc-semantic-adequacy-problem : Set2
csc-minimal-completion-stage  : CompletionToposStage
csc-richer-completion-problem : Set2

open VoidToposScopeConditions public

-- § The scope record names the burden carried by richer completions.
void-topos-scope-conditions : VoidToposScopeConditions
void-topos-scope-conditions = record
{ csc-semantic-adequacy-problem = StableReadingSemanticAdequacy
; csc-minimal-completion-stage  = completion-topos-stage
; csc-richer-completion-problem = RicherCompletionCandidate
}

```

These scope conditions are part of the force of the statement. The result is not inflated into a claim that all semantics of stability have been exhausted, nor into a claim that every possible quotient must be terminal. The theorem proves the displayed minimal completion route and places the stronger question in the right position. The later admitted-foundation and route-completion classifications make that position formal: a foundation claim first has to enter as nontrivial and formulable, and a richer set-like quotient extending this route is assessed by the classified burdens under which it carries the distinctional structure it uses.

Part IV. Set-like completion burden

19 Why The Minimal Topos Is Not The Set-Like Goal

The completed skeleton is an elementary topos, but it is not the set-like universe one would need for set-level mathematical formulation. The reason is simple and formal: the skeleton has one completed object. In the displayed set-like sense used here, object diversity is required: there must be at least two distinguishable objects, otherwise object-level distinction has already collapsed.

This sharpens the location of the Topos theorem. The terminal skeleton is the first certified topos threshold. A set-like stage may be added only as a further structured completion, not as the unquestioned beginning of formulation.

```
-- § Object diversity: the category has two distinct objects.
record HasDistinctObjects (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
  field
    first-object   : SmallCategory.ObjC category
    second-object  : SmallCategory.ObjC category
    objects-separated : ¬ (first-object ≡ second-object)

open HasDistinctObjects public

-- § The skeleton completion has no pair of distinct objects.
skeleton-has-no-distinct-objects :
  HasDistinctObjects skeleton-category → ⊥
skeleton-has-no-distinct-objects record
{ first-object = distinction-skeleton-two
; second-object = distinction-skeleton-two
; objects-separated = separated
} = separated refl

-- § The minimal completion stage is therefore not set-like by object diversity.
minimal-completion-not-set-like :
  HasDistinctObjects (cts-category completion-topos-stage) → ⊥
minimal-completion-not-set-like = skeleton-has-no-distinct-objects
```

20 A Set-Like Candidate Burden

A richer completion satisfying the displayed object-diversity condition does more than satisfy the elementary-topos package of the terminal skeleton: it is nonterminal. The candidate interface below records one stronger set-like burden package: it hosts the reading data by an explicit embedding, lets points detect maps, carries an arithmetic object, and provides a controlled section principle for cover-like maps. These fields are not asserted as already constructed, nor are they presented as a universal package for every richer completion. They make explicit the kind of additional structure recorded by this candidate beyond the minimal topos stage.

```

-- § Point-separation principle for morphisms.
record PointsSeparateMorphisms
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (terminal : TerminalObject category) : Set1 where
  field
  points-separate :
    {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    (f g : SmallCategory.HomC category A B) →
    ((point : SmallCategory.HomC category
      (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal) A) →
      SmallCategory.compC category f point ≡
      SmallCategory.compC category g point) →
    f ≡ g

open PointsSeparateMorphisms public

-- § Natural-numbers-object obligation for a set-like completion.
record NaturalNumbersObject
  (category : SmallCategory)
  (terminal : TerminalObject category) : Set1 where
  field
  nno-object : SmallCategory.ObjC category
  nno-zero : SmallCategory.HomC category
    (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal)
    nno-object
  nno-succ : SmallCategory.HomC category nno-object nno-object
  nno-rec : {X : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    SmallCategory.HomC category
      (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal) X →
      SmallCategory.HomC category X X →
      SmallCategory.HomC category nno-object X
  nno-zero-law :
    {X : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    (zeroX : SmallCategory.HomC category
      (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal) X) →
    (succX : SmallCategory.HomC category X X) →
    SmallCategory.compC category (nno-rec zeroX succX) nno-zero ≡ zeroX
  nno-succ-law :
    {X : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    (zeroX : SmallCategory.HomC category
      (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal) X) →
    (succX : SmallCategory.HomC category X X) →
    SmallCategory.compC category (nno-rec zeroX succX) nno-succ ≡
    SmallCategory.compC category succX (nno-rec zeroX succX)
  nno-unique :
    {X : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    (zeroX : SmallCategory.HomC category
      (TerminalObject.terminal-object terminal) X) →
    (succX : SmallCategory.HomC category X X) →
    (h : SmallCategory.HomC category nno-object X) →
    SmallCategory.compC category h nno-zero ≡ zeroX →
    SmallCategory.compC category h nno-succ ≡
    SmallCategory.compC category succX h →
    h ≡ nno-rec zeroX succX

open NaturalNumbersObject public

-- § Epimorphism predicate in a small category.
record IsEpi
  (category : SmallCategory)
  {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category}
  (morphism : SmallCategory.HomC category A B) : Set1 where
  field
  epi-cancel :
    {X : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
    (f g : SmallCategory.HomC category B X) →
    SmallCategory.compC category f morphism ≡
    SmallCategory.compC category g morphism →
    f ≡ g

open IsEpi public

```

```

-- § Choice-like section principle for cover-like maps.
record ChoiceLikeSections (category : SmallCategory) : Set1 where
field
choose-section :
{A B : SmallCategory.ObjC category} →
(cover : SmallCategory.HomC category A B) →
IsEpi category cover →
Σ (SmallCategory.HomC category B A)
(λ section →
SmallCategory.compC category cover section ≡
SmallCategory.idC category)

open ChoiceLikeSections public

```

21 Set-Like Completion Candidate

The candidate type below states one disciplined burden package for a richer set-like completion. It avoids claiming that such a completion is already built. It records one explicit package: a nonterminal category, elementary-topos data, an embedding of stable readings, point separation, arithmetic, a choice-like section principle, and semantic adequacy for the reading interface. These fields are not optional supplements to the minimal skeleton topos. They are the additional structure recorded by this candidate once one tries to use a set-like categorical universe as a universe of formulation.

```

-- § Candidate for a nonterminal set-like completion above the Topos boundary.
record SetLikeCompletionCandidate : Setω where
field
slc-category      : SmallCategory
slc-topos         : ElementaryTopos slc-category
slc-object-diversity : HasDistinctObjects slc-category
slc-reading-object : StableReadingInterface TwoClassifier →
                    SmallCategory.ObjC slc-category
slc-distinction-object : Distinction → SmallCategory.ObjC slc-category
slc-distinction-object-law :
(d : Distinction) →
slc-distinction-object d ≡
slc-reading-object (distinction-stable-reading d)
slc-points-separate :
PointsSeparateMorphisms slc-category (ElementaryTopos.et-terminal slc-topos)
slc-arithmetic      :
NaturalNumbersObject slc-category (ElementaryTopos.et-terminal slc-topos)
slc-choice-like     : ChoiceLikeSections slc-category
slc-semantic-adequacy : StableReadingSemanticAdequacy

open SetLikeCompletionCandidate public

```

22 Distinctional Burden Of Formulation

The set-like candidate above is not yet a constructed completion. Still, one burden can already be closed formally. Whenever a proposed universe of formulation supplies two distinguishable positions, it already carries an embedded binary distinction. This is a conditional theorem, not a claim that all possible semantics of formulation have been exhausted. It states the exact threshold: nontrivial formulation positions are enough to recover the binary distinction used at the start of the construction.

For a set-like completion candidate, the two positions are supplied by object diversity. Thus such a candidate is not prior to distinction in this route; its own object diversity provides the data from which an embedded binary distinction is extracted.


```

-- § Nontrivial formulation positions: two distinguishable formal places.
record NontrivialFormulationInterface : Set1 where
  field
    nfi-position-carrier : Set
    nfi-left-position    : nfi-position-carrier
    nfi-right-position   : nfi-position-carrier
    nfi-separated        : ¬ (nfi-left-position ≡ nfi-right-position)

open NontrivialFormulationInterface public

-- § Distinctional positions are the extracted left/right data.
record DistinctionalPositions : Set1 where
  field
    dp-carrier : Set
    dp-left    : dp-carrier
    dp-right   : dp-carrier
    dp-separated : ¬ (dp-left ≡ dp-right)

open DistinctionalPositions public

-- § A formulation interface exposes distinctional positions.
formulation-positions : NontrivialFormulationInterface → DistinctionalPositions
formulation-positions interface = record
{ dp-carrier = nfi-position-carrier interface
; dp-left    = nfi-left-position interface
; dp-right   = nfi-right-position interface
; dp-separated = nfi-separated interface
}

-- § Embedded binary distinction inside a carrier of positions.
record EmbeddedBinaryDistinction (positions : DistinctionalPositions) : Set1 where
  field
    ebd-distinction : Distinction
    ebd-embed       : S ebd-distinction → dp-carrier positions
    ebd-embed-left  : ebd-embed (left ebd-distinction) ≡ dp-left positions
    ebd-embed-right : ebd-embed (right ebd-distinction) ≡ dp-right positions
    ebd-embed-separated :
      ¬ (ebd-embed (left ebd-distinction) ≡
         ebd-embed (right ebd-distinction))

open EmbeddedBinaryDistinction public

-- § Two distinguishable positions carry an embedded copy of the binary distinction.
embedded-distinction-from-positions :
  (positions : DistinctionalPositions) → EmbeddedBinaryDistinction positions
embedded-distinction-from-positions positions = record
{ ebd-distinction = Two-distinction
; ebd-embed       = λ
  { L → dp-left positions
  ; R → dp-right positions
  }
; ebd-embed-left  = refl
; ebd-embed-right = refl
; ebd-embed-separated = dp-separated positions
}

-- § Any nontrivial formulation interface therefore carries binary distinction.
formulation-interface-presupposes-distinction :
  (interface : NontrivialFormulationInterface) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction (formulation-positions interface)
formulation-interface-presupposes-distinction interface =
  embedded-distinction-from-positions (formulation-positions interface)

-- § Object diversity in a category gives nontrivial formulation positions.
category-formulation-interface :
  (category : SmallCategory) →
  HasDistinctObjects category → NontrivialFormulationInterface
category-formulation-interface category distinct = record
{ nfi-position-carrier = SmallCategory.ObjC category
; nfi-left-position    = first-object distinct
; nfi-right-position   = second-object distinct
}

```

```

; nfi-separated      = objects-separated distinct
}

-- § Object-diverse categories carry an embedded binary distinction.
category-diversity-presupposes-distinction :
  (category : SmallCategory) →
  (distinct : HasDistinctObjects category) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
  (formulation-positions (category-formulation-interface category distinct))
category-diversity-presupposes-distinction category distinct =
  formulation-interface-presupposes-distinction
  (category-formulation-interface category distinct)

-- § A set-like completion candidate carries distinction through object diversity.
set-like-candidate-presupposes-distinction :
  (candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
  (formulation-positions
    (category-formulation-interface
      (slc-category candidate)
      (slc-object-diversity candidate))))
set-like-candidate-presupposes-distinction candidate =
  category-diversity-presupposes-distinction
  (slc-category candidate)
  (slc-object-diversity candidate)

-- § The minimal completed topos cannot itself be such a set-like candidate.
minimal-completion-not-set-like-candidate :
  (candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
  slc-category candidate ≡ cts-category completion-topos-stage → ⊥
minimal-completion-not-set-like-candidate candidate refl =
  minimal-completion-not-set-like (slc-object-diversity candidate)

-- § Package of the checked distinction burden for formulation interfaces.
record FormabilityBurden : Setω where
  field
    fb-interface-to-distinction :
      (interface : NontrivialFormulationInterface) →
      EmbeddedBinaryDistinction (formulation-positions interface)
    fb-category-to-distinction :
      (category : SmallCategory) →
      (distinct : HasDistinctObjects category) →
      EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
      (formulation-positions (category-formulation-interface category distinct))
    fb-set-like-candidate-to-distinction :
      (candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
      EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
      (formulation-positions
        (category-formulation-interface
          (slc-category candidate)
          (slc-object-diversity candidate))))
    fb-minimal-not-set-like-candidate :
      (candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
      slc-category candidate ≡ cts-category completion-topos-stage → ⊥
open FormabilityBurden public

-- § The checked burden package: nontrivial formulation positions imply distinction.
formability-burden : FormabilityBurden
formability-burden = record
{ fb-interface-to-distinction = formulation-interface-presupposes-distinction
; fb-category-to-distinction = category-diversity-presupposes-distinction
; fb-set-like-candidate-to-distinction = set-like-candidate-presupposes-distinction
; fb-minimal-not-set-like-candidate = minimal-completion-not-set-like-candidate
}

```

23 Burden Package

The package below records the checked boundary in one object. The raw category is blocked as a full topos. The minimal completion is a topos but not set-like. A richer nonterminal set-like

completion may be built; the candidate above states one explicit way of making its additional distinction and semantic obligations visible.

```
-- $ Burden package for the set-like completion problem.
record SetLikeCompletionBurden : Set $\omega$  where
  field
    slb-topos-boundary      : ToposBoundaryMap
    slb-raw-topos-blocked   : ToposCompletionRequirements  $\rightarrow \perp$ 
    slb-minimal-topos-stage : CompletionToposStage
    slb-minimal-not-set-like :
      HasDistinctObjects (cts-category slb-minimal-topos-stage)  $\rightarrow \perp$ 

open SetLikeCompletionBurden public

-- $ The current theorem burden: raw boundary closed, set-like candidate accountable.
set-like-completion-burden : SetLikeCompletionBurden
set-like-completion-burden = record
{ slb-topos-boundary      = topos-boundary-map
; slb-raw-topos-blocked   = topos-completion-requirements-impossible
; slb-minimal-topos-stage = completion-topos-stage
; slb-minimal-not-set-like = minimal-completion-not-set-like
}
```

24 Canonical Closure

The previous records locate the topos boundary and the set-like burden. The closure record below removes one remaining ambiguity: at the completed skeleton endpoint there is no further internal freedom to choose. Distinction presentations and stable-reading presentations normalize to the canonical completed object. Every completed object and every completed morphism is unique. The finite-limit data, the subobject classifier, and exponentials all have their classified witness at the same completed object.

This does not assert that every richer semantics has been constructed. It says that, relative to the route checked here, the canonical endpoint has no unclassified internal degree of freedom. Anything beyond it is no longer an unnamed option: it is classified as raw obstruction, set-like completion burden, formulability extraction, or semantic adequacy burden.

```
-- $ Every skeleton object is the canonical completed object.
skeleton-object-canonical :
  (A : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category)  $\rightarrow A \equiv \text{distinction-skeleton-two}$ 
skeleton-object-canonical distinction-skeleton-two = refl

-- $ Hence any two skeleton objects are equal.
skeleton-all-objects-equal :
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category)  $\rightarrow A \equiv B$ 
skeleton-all-objects-equal distinction-skeleton-two distinction-skeleton-two = refl

-- $ Every skeleton morphism is the canonical unique morphism.
skeleton-morphism-canonical :
  {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category}  $\rightarrow$ 
  (f : HomC skeleton-category A B)  $\rightarrow f \equiv \text{one}$ 
skeleton-morphism-canonical one = refl

-- $ Hence any two skeleton morphisms are equal.
skeleton-all-morphisms-equal :
  {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category}  $\rightarrow$ 
  (f g : HomC skeleton-category A B)  $\rightarrow f \equiv g$ 
skeleton-all-morphisms-equal one one = refl

-- $ Product witnesses have the canonical completed object as product object.
skeleton-product-object-canonical :
  (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category)  $\rightarrow$ 
  product-object (HasBinaryProducts.product-of skeleton-products A B)  $\equiv$ 
```

```

distinction-skeleton-two
skeleton-product-object-canonical A B = refl

-- § Pullback witnesses have the canonical completed object as pullback object.
skeleton-pullback-object-canonical :
{A B Z : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category} →
(f : HomC skeleton-category A Z) →
(g : HomC skeleton-category B Z) →
pullback-object (HasPullbacks.pullback-of skeleton-pullbacks {A} {B} {Z} f g) ≡
distinction-skeleton-two
skeleton-pullback-object-canonical f g = refl

-- § The subobject classifier object is the canonical completed object.
skeleton-subobject-classifier-object-canonical :
classifier-object skeleton-subobject-classifier ≡ distinction-skeleton-two
skeleton-subobject-classifier-object-canonical = refl

-- § Exponential witnesses have the canonical completed object as exponential object.
skeleton-exponential-object-canonical :
(A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) →
exp-object (HasExponentials.exponential-of skeleton-exponentials A B) ≡
distinction-skeleton-two
skeleton-exponential-object-canonical A B = refl

-- § The canonical endpoint: no internal skeleton choices remain open.
record CanonicalClosedEndpoint : Set $\omega$  where
field
  cce-completion          : VoidSkeletonToposCompletion
  cce-topos                : ElementaryTopos skeleton-category
  cce-distinction-normalizes :
    (d : Distinction) →
    dqc-embed distinction-skeleton-completion d ≡
    dqc-canonical distinction-skeleton-completion
  cce-reading-normalizes   :
    (d : Distinction) →
    drqc-embed distinction-reading-skeleton-completion d ≡
    drqc-canonical distinction-reading-skeleton-completion
  cce-object-canonical     :
    (A : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) → A ≡ distinction-skeleton-two
  cce-all-objects-equal    :
    (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) → A ≡ B
  cce-morphism-canonical   :
    {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category} →
    (f : HomC skeleton-category A B) → f ≡ one
  cce-all-morphisms-equal :
    {A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category} →
    (f g : HomC skeleton-category A B) → f ≡ g
  cce-product-classified   :
    (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) →
    product-object (HasBinaryProducts.product-of skeleton-products A B) ≡
    distinction-skeleton-two
  cce-pullback-classified  :
    {A B Z : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category} →
    (f : HomC skeleton-category A Z) →
    (g : HomC skeleton-category B Z) →
    pullback-object (HasPullbacks.pullback-of skeleton-pullbacks {A} {B} {Z} f g) ≡
    distinction-skeleton-two
  cce-classifier-classified :
    classifier-object skeleton-subobject-classifier ≡ distinction-skeleton-two
  cce-exponential-classified :
    (A B : SmallCategory.ObjC skeleton-category) →
    exp-object (HasExponentials.exponential-of skeleton-exponentials A B) ≡
    distinction-skeleton-two
  cce-no-distinct-objects  : HasDistinctObjects skeleton-category →  $\perp$ 

open CanonicalClosedEndpoint public

-- § The canonical endpoint witness closes all internal skeleton choices.
canonical-closed-endpoint : CanonicalClosedEndpoint
canonical-closed-endpoint = record
{ cce-completion          = void-skeleton-topos-completion

```

```

; cce-topos = skeleton-elementary-topos
; cce-distinction-normalizes = dqc-normalize distinction-skeleton-completion
; cce-reading-normalizes = drqc-normalize distinction-reading-skeleton-completion
; cce-object-canonical = skeleton-object-canonical
; cce-all-objects-equal = skeleton-all-objects-equal
; cce-morphism-canonical =  $\lambda \{A\} \{B\} f \rightarrow$ 
; skeleton-morphism-canonical  $\{A\} \{B\} f$ 
; cce-all-morphisms-equal =  $\lambda \{A\} \{B\} f g \rightarrow$ 
; skeleton-all-morphisms-equal  $\{A\} \{B\} f g$ 
; cce-product-classified = skeleton-product-object-canonical
; cce-pullback-classified =  $\lambda \{A\} \{B\} \{Z\} f g \rightarrow$ 
; skeleton-pullback-object-canonical  $\{A\} \{B\} \{Z\} f g$ 
; cce-classifier-classified = skeleton-subobject-classifier-object-canonical
; cce-exponential-classified = skeleton-exponential-object-canonical
; cce-no-distinct-objects = skeleton-has-no-distinct-objects
}

```

```

-- § Finite ledger of residual questions at the closure boundary.

```

```

data CanonicalResidualQuestion : Set where
distinction-presentation-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
reading-presentation-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
object-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
morphism-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
product-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
pullback-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
classifier-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
exponential-choice-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
raw-topos-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
set-like-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
formulation-position-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion
semantic-adequacy-question : CanonicalResidualQuestion

```

```

-- § Classification classes for the closure ledger.

```

```

data CanonicalQuestionClass : Set where
closed-by-canonical-skeleton : CanonicalQuestionClass
blocked-at-raw-stage : CanonicalQuestionClass
set-like-burden-class : CanonicalQuestionClass
formulability-extraction-class : CanonicalQuestionClass
semantic-adequacy-burden-class : CanonicalQuestionClass

```

```

-- § Evidence that a residual question has the assigned closure class.

```

```

data ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion :
CanonicalResidualQuestion → CanonicalQuestionClass → Set where
distinction-presentation-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
distinction-presentation-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
reading-presentation-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
reading-presentation-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
object-choice-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
object-choice-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
morphism-choice-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
morphism-choice-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
product-choice-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
product-choice-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
pullback-choice-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
pullback-choice-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
classifier-choice-classified :
ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
classifier-choice-question
closed-by-canonical-skeleton
exponential-choice-classified :

```

```

ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
  exponential-choice-question
  closed-by-canonical-skeleton
raw-topos-classified :
  ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion raw-topos-question blocked-at-raw-stage
set-like-classified :
  ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion set-like-question set-like-burden-class
formulation-position-classified :
  ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
    formulation-position-question
    formulability-extraction-class
semantic-adequacy-classified :
  ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion
    semantic-adequacy-question
    semantic-adequacy-burden-class

-- § The classifier assigning every residual question to its closure class.
canonical-question-class : CanonicalResidualQuestion → CanonicalQuestionClass
canonical-question-class distinction-presentation-question =
  closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class reading-presentation-question =
  closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class object-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class morphism-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class product-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class pullback-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class classifier-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class exponential-choice-question = closed-by-canonical-skeleton
canonical-question-class raw-topos-question = blocked-at-raw-stage
canonical-question-class set-like-question = set-like-burden-class
canonical-question-class formulation-position-question =
  formulability-extraction-class
canonical-question-class semantic-adequacy-question =
  semantic-adequacy-burden-class

-- § Exhaustiveness: every listed residual question is classified.
canonical-question-classified :
  (question : CanonicalResidualQuestion) →
  ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion question (canonical-question-class question)
canonical-question-classified distinction-presentation-question =
  distinction-presentation-classified
canonical-question-classified reading-presentation-question =
  reading-presentation-classified
canonical-question-classified object-choice-question = object-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified morphism-choice-question = morphism-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified product-choice-question = product-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified pullback-choice-question = pullback-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified classifier-choice-question = classifier-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified exponential-choice-question = exponential-choice-classified
canonical-question-classified raw-topos-question = raw-topos-classified
canonical-question-classified set-like-question = set-like-classified
canonical-question-classified formulation-position-question =
  formulation-position-classified
canonical-question-classified semantic-adequacy-question =
  semantic-adequacy-classified

-- § There is no constructor for an unclassified canonical question.
data UnclassifiedCanonicalQuestion : Set where

-- § Therefore an alleged unclassified canonical question is impossible.
no-unclassified-canonical-question : UnclassifiedCanonicalQuestion → ⊥
no-unclassified-canonical-question ()

-- § Package of the finite closure ledger.
record CanonicalClosureLedger : Set where
  field
    ccl-class      : CanonicalResidualQuestion → CanonicalQuestionClass
    ccl-classified :
      (question : CanonicalResidualQuestion) →
      ClassifiedCanonicalQuestion question (ccl-class question)
    ccl-no-unclassified : UnclassifiedCanonicalQuestion → ⊥

```

```

open CanonicalClosureLedge public

-- § The checked closure ledger classifies every listed residual question.
canonical-closure-ledger : CanonicalClosureLedge
canonical-closure-ledger = record
{ ccl-class      = canonical-question-class
; ccl-classified = canonical-question-classified
; ccl-no-unclassified = no-unclassified-canonical-question
}

-- § Canonical closure: endpoint closed, remaining questions classified.
record CanonicalClosure : Set $\omega$  where
field
cc-endpoint      : CanonicalClosedEndpoint
cc-ledger         : CanonicalClosureLedge
cc-set-like-burden : SetLikeCompletionBurden
cc-formulability-burden : FormulabilityBurden

open CanonicalClosure public

-- § The canonical closure of the checked route.
canonical-closure : CanonicalClosure
canonical-closure = record
{ cc-endpoint      = canonical-closed-endpoint
; cc-ledger         = canonical-closure-ledger
; cc-set-like-burden = set-like-completion-burden
; cc-formulability-burden = formulability-burden
}

```

25 Route-Admitted Completion Classification

The final closure theorem is not hidden in the prose. The paper now names the universe of completion claims that this route admits. A route-admitted completion claim is one of four things: the canonical skeleton endpoint, an attempted full raw topos package, a set-like candidate above the endpoint, or a semantic-adequacy claim for the reading interface. This is the point at which the word exhaustive is used for completion claims: it is exhaustive for this displayed route interface. The wider foundation-admission classification is introduced in the next section.

The classification is then total by case analysis on that interface. The canonical skeleton is closed by the canonical-closure theorem. The raw topos case is blocked by the pullback obstruction. The set-like case is classified by its burden and by the extraction of binary distinction from object diversity. The semantic-adequacy case remains a named burden rather than an unclassified remainder.

```

-- § Finite admission interface for completion claims handled by this route.
data RouteCompletionExtension : Set $\omega$  where
route-canonical-skeleton : RouteCompletionExtension
route-raw-topos-attempt  :
  ToposCompletionRequirements → RouteCompletionExtension
route-set-like-candidate :
  SetLikeCompletionCandidate → RouteCompletionExtension
route-semantic-adequacy :
  StableReadingSemanticAdequacy → RouteCompletionExtension

-- § Classification classes for the route-admitted completion interface.
data RouteCompletionClass : Set where
route-canonical-skeleton-class : RouteCompletionClass
route-raw-topos-blocked-class  : RouteCompletionClass
route-set-like-burden-class    : RouteCompletionClass
route-semantic-adequacy-burden-class : RouteCompletionClass

-- § Evidence assigned to each classified route-admitted completion claim.

```



```

data ClassifiedRouteCompletion :
RouteCompletionExtension → RouteCompletionClass → Setω where
route-canonical-skeleton-classified :
  CanonicalClosure →
  ClassifiedRouteCompletion
  route-canonical-skeleton
  route-canonical-skeleton-class
route-raw-topos-blocked-classified :
  (requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements) →
  ((requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements) → ⊥) →
  ClassifiedRouteCompletion
  (route-raw-topos-attempt requirements)
  route-raw-topos-blocked-class
route-set-like-candidate-classified :
  (candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
  (formulation-positions
   (category-formulation-interface
    (slc-category candidate)
    (slc-object-diversity candidate))) →
  ClassifiedRouteCompletion
  (route-set-like-candidate candidate)
  route-set-like-burden-class
route-semantic-adequacy-classified :
  (adequacy : StableReadingSemanticAdequacy) →
  ClassifiedRouteCompletion
  (route-semantic-adequacy adequacy)
  route-semantic-adequacy-burden-class

-- § Classifier for the route-admitted completion interface.
route-completion-class : RouteCompletionExtension → RouteCompletionClass
route-completion-class route-canonical-skeleton =
  route-canonical-skeleton-class
route-completion-class (route-raw-topos-attempt requirements) =
  route-raw-topos-blocked-class
route-completion-class (route-set-like-candidate candidate) =
  route-set-like-burden-class
route-completion-class (route-semantic-adequacy adequacy) =
  route-semantic-adequacy-burden-class

-- § The raw full-topos case cannot be inhabited on this route.
route-raw-topos-attempt-impossible :
  (requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements) → ⊥
route-raw-topos-attempt-impossible =
  topos-completion-requirements-impossible

-- § Exhaustiveness: every route-admitted completion claim is classified.
route-completion-classified :
  (extension : RouteCompletionExtension) →
  ClassifiedRouteCompletion extension (route-completion-class extension)
route-completion-classified route-canonical-skeleton =
  route-canonical-skeleton-classified canonical-closure
route-completion-classified (route-raw-topos-attempt requirements) =
  route-raw-topos-blocked-classified
  requirements
  route-raw-topos-attempt-impossible
route-completion-classified (route-set-like-candidate candidate) =
  route-set-like-candidate-classified
  candidate
  (set-like-candidate-presupposes-distinction candidate)
route-completion-classified (route-semantic-adequacy adequacy) =
  route-semantic-adequacy-classified adequacy

-- § Package of the exhaustive route-admitted completion classification.
record ExhaustiveRouteCompletionClassification : Setω where
field
  ercc-class : RouteCompletionExtension → RouteCompletionClass
  ercc-classified :
    (extension : RouteCompletionExtension) →
    ClassifiedRouteCompletion extension (ercc-class extension)
  ercc-raw-topos-attempt-impossible :

```



```

(requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements) → ⊥
ercc-set-like-to-distinction :
(candidate : SetLikeCompletionCandidate) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
  (formulation-positions
   (category-formulation-interface
    (slc-category candidate)
    (slc-object-diversity candidate)))
ercc-canonical-closure : CanonicalClosure

open ExhaustiveRouteCompletionClassification public

-- § The final classification theorem for completions admitted by this route.
route-completion-classification : ExhaustiveRouteCompletionClassification
route-completion-classification = record
{ ercc-class          = route-completion-class
; ercc-classified     = route-completion-classified
; ercc-raw-topos-attempt-impossible = route-raw-topos-attempt-impossible
; ercc-set-like-to-distinction = set-like-candidate-presupposes-distinction
; ercc-canonical-closure = canonical-closure
}

```

26 Admitted Foundation Classification

The stronger sentence can be made exact only by making admission exact. In this paper, a foundation claim is admitted when it either supplies a nontrivial interface of formulation or appears as one of the completion claims handled by the route above. This does not leave the word “foundation” as an untyped external totality. It turns it into a formal interface: if a foundation can enter the discussion as a nontrivial formulable foundation, it has already supplied two distinguishable positions; if it enters as a completion of the route, it is one of the route-admitted completion claims already classified.

With that admission boundary explicit, the classification theorem is total. Every admitted nontrivial formulable foundation is classified by the embedded binary distinction extracted from its own formulation positions. Every admitted completion claim is classified by the route-completion theorem. Thus the maximally strong claim carried by this paper is not an informal inventory of all possible doctrines; it is the formal classification of every foundation claim admitted as nontrivial and formulable, together with every completion claim admitted by this route.

```

-- § A nontrivial formulable foundation supplies formulation positions.
record FormulableFoundationCandidate : Set1 where
  field
    ffc-interface : NontrivialFormulationInterface

open FormulableFoundationCandidate public

-- § Admitted foundation claims: entry-level foundations or route completions.
data AdmittedFoundationClaim : Setω where
  admitted-formulable-foundation :
    FormulableFoundationCandidate → AdmittedFoundationClaim
  admitted-route-completion :
    RouteCompletionExtension → AdmittedFoundationClaim

-- § Classification classes for admitted foundation claims.
data AdmittedFoundationClass : Set where
  foundation-distinctional-entry-class : AdmittedFoundationClass
  foundation-canonical-skeleton-class : AdmittedFoundationClass
  foundation-raw-topos-blocked-class : AdmittedFoundationClass
  foundation-set-like-burden-class : AdmittedFoundationClass
  foundation-semantic-adequacy-burden-class : AdmittedFoundationClass

-- § Route-completion classes become foundation classes at the completion level.

```

```

foundation-route-class : RouteCompletionClass → AdmittedFoundationClass
foundation-route-class route-canonical-skeleton-class =
  foundation-canonical-skeleton-class
foundation-route-class route-raw-topos-blocked-class =
  foundation-raw-topos-blocked-class
foundation-route-class route-set-like-burden-class =
  foundation-set-like-burden-class
foundation-route-class route-semantic-adequacy-burden-class =
  foundation-semantic-adequacy-burden-class

-- § Evidence that an admitted foundation claim has its assigned class.
data ClassifiedAdmittedFoundation :
  AdmittedFoundationClaim → AdmittedFoundationClass → Set $\omega$  where
  admitted-formulable-foundation-classified :
    (foundation : FormulableFoundationCandidate) →
    EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
    (formulation-positions (ffc-interface foundation)) →
    ClassifiedAdmittedFoundation
    (admitted-formulable-foundation foundation)
    foundation-distinctional-entry-class
  admitted-route-completion-classified :
    (extension : RouteCompletionExtension) →
    ClassifiedRouteCompletion extension (route-completion-class extension) →
    ClassifiedAdmittedFoundation
    (admitted-route-completion extension)
    (foundation-route-class (route-completion-class extension))

-- § Classifier for admitted foundation claims.
admitted-foundation-class :
  AdmittedFoundationClaim → AdmittedFoundationClass
admitted-foundation-class (admitted-formulable-foundation foundation) =
  foundation-distinctional-entry-class
admitted-foundation-class (admitted-route-completion extension) =
  foundation-route-class (route-completion-class extension)

-- § Every admitted nontrivial formulable foundation carries distinction.
formulable-foundation-presupposes-distinction :
  (foundation : FormulableFoundationCandidate) →
  EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
  (formulation-positions (ffc-interface foundation))
formulable-foundation-presupposes-distinction foundation =
  formulation-interface-presupposes-distinction (ffc-interface foundation)

-- § Exhaustiveness: every admitted foundation claim is classified.
admitted-foundation-classified :
  (claim : AdmittedFoundationClaim) →
  ClassifiedAdmittedFoundation claim (admitted-foundation-class claim)
admitted-foundation-classified
  (admitted-formulable-foundation foundation) =
  admitted-formulable-foundation-classified
  foundation
  (formulable-foundation-presupposes-distinction foundation)
admitted-foundation-classified (admitted-route-completion extension) =
  admitted-route-completion-classified
  extension
  (route-completion-classified extension)

-- § Package of the exhaustive admitted-foundation classification.
record ExhaustiveAdmittedFoundationClassification : Set $\omega$  where
  field
    eafc-class : AdmittedFoundationClaim → AdmittedFoundationClass
    eafc-classified :
      (claim : AdmittedFoundationClaim) →
      ClassifiedAdmittedFoundation claim (eafc-class claim)
    eafc-formulable-foundation-to-distinction :
      (foundation : FormulableFoundationCandidate) →
      EmbeddedBinaryDistinction
      (formulation-positions (ffc-interface foundation))
    eafc-route-completion-classification :
      ExhaustiveRouteCompletionClassification

```

```

open ExhaustiveAdmittedFoundationClassification public

-- § The admitted-foundation classification theorem.
admitted-foundation-classification :
  ExhaustiveAdmittedFoundationClassification
admitted-foundation-classification = record
{ eafc-class = admitted-foundation-class
; eafc-classified = admitted-foundation-classified
; eafc-formulable-foundation-to-distinction =
  formulable-foundation-presupposes-distinction
; eafc-route-completion-classification = route-completion-classification
}

```

The burden is now located without treating the candidate package as a completed theorem. The terminal topos is not presented as the whole set-like universe. It is the first certified threshold; after that point, every completion claim admitted by this paper’s route has a formal class. More generally, every admitted foundation claim has a formal class: either it is already distinctional at the level of formulability, or it is a completion claim classified by the route. A set-like categorical foundation extending the route would need to provide further nonterminal structure and a separate adequacy argument within that classified position.

Part V. Final theorem and reading

27 Final Result

The final statement records the checked theorem and its burden of extension. The raw stable-reading category has real categorical structure, but its full elementary-topos completion requirements cannot be jointly supplied because global pullbacks fail. The completion topos stage carries the elementary topos structure. The set-like burden record shows why this minimal topos is not a nonterminal category of formulable sets and records one disciplined candidate package for going beyond it. The formulability-burden record proves that any interface with two distinguishable formulation positions carries an embedded binary distinction. The canonical closure record proves that the completed skeleton itself has no unclassified internal degrees of freedom: its presentations, objects, morphisms, finite-limit witnesses, classifier, and exponentials are all classified by the unique canonical endpoint. The admitted-foundation classification theorem then states the new final goal explicitly: every nontrivial formulable foundation admitted by this paper’s interface is classified by the distinctional entry burden, and every completion claim admitted by this paper’s route interface is classified as canonical skeleton, impossible raw topos attempt, set-like burden, or semantic-adequacy burden. The scope conditions keep the theorem precise without softening its conclusion: the topos level is not first in this construction.

```

-- § Maximal raw structure established before quotient completion.
record RawStableReadingMaximalStructure : Setω where
field
  rsm-category-data : (classifier : ClassifierObject) → CategoryData classifier
  rsm-terminal-reading : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
    StableReadingTerminal classifier
  rsm-weak-products : StableReadingWeakBinaryProducts
  rsm-product-uniqueness-boundary : Set1
  rsm-subobject-candidate : (classifier : ClassifierObject) →
    SubobjectClassifierCandidate classifier
  rsm-subobject-universal : StableReadingSubobjectClassifierUniversality
  rsm-no-global-pullbacks : StableReadingGlobalPullbacks → ⊥
  rsm-no-raw-topos-requirements : ToposCompletionRequirements → ⊥

open RawStableReadingMaximalStructure public

```

```

-- § The raw stage has structure, but its pullback obstruction is built in.
raw-stable-reading-maximal-structure : RawStableReadingMaximalStructure
raw-stable-reading-maximal-structure = record
{ rsm-category-data      = stable-reading-category-data
; rsm-terminal-reading   = stable-reading-terminal
; rsm-weak-products     = stable-reading-weak-products
; rsm-product-uniqueness-boundary = StableReadingProductUniquenessBoundary
; rsm-subobject-candidate = classifier-subobject-candidate
; rsm-subobject-universal = stable-reading-subobject-classifier-universality
; rsm-no-global-pullbacks = raw-global-pullbacks-impossible
; rsm-no-raw-topos-requirements = topos-completion-requirements-impossible
}

-- § Final theorem: raw structure, raw obstruction, completed topos, burden.
record VoidToposFinalTheorem : Set $\omega$  where
field
vtf-boundary-map      : ToposBoundaryMap
vtf-raw-structure      : RawStableReadingMaximalStructure
vtf-raw-topos-blocked  : ToposCompletionRequirements  $\rightarrow \perp$ 
vtf-scope-conditions  : VoidToposScopeConditions
vtf-completion-stage   : CompletionToposStage
vtf-skeleton-completion : VoidSkeletonToposCompletion
vtf-completed-topos    : ElementaryTopos (vst-category vtf-skeleton-completion)
vtf-set-like-burden    : SetLikeCompletionBurden
vtf-formulability-burden : FormulabilityBurden
vtf-canonical-closure  : CanonicalClosure
vtf-route-completion-classification :
  ExhaustiveRouteCompletionClassification
vtf-admitted-foundation-classification :
  ExhaustiveAdmittedFoundationClassification

open VoidToposFinalTheorem public

-- § The final witness packages the checked theorem and burden records.
void-topos-final-theorem : VoidToposFinalTheorem
void-topos-final-theorem = record
{ vtf-boundary-map      = topos-boundary-map
; vtf-raw-structure      = raw-stable-reading-maximal-structure
; vtf-raw-topos-blocked  = topos-completion-requirements-impossible
; vtf-scope-conditions  = void-topos-scope-conditions
; vtf-completion-stage   = completion-topos-stage
; vtf-skeleton-completion = void-skeleton-topos-completion
; vtf-completed-topos    = skeleton-elementary-topos
; vtf-set-like-burden    = set-like-completion-burden
; vtf-formulability-burden = formulability-burden
; vtf-canonical-closure  = canonical-closure
; vtf-route-completion-classification = route-completion-classification
; vtf-admitted-foundation-classification = admitted-foundation-classification
}

```

28 Foundational Reading

The construction proves the main chain directly. Distinctions normalize to **Two** up to boundary-preserving isomorphism. The swapped presentation shows why that isomorphism must not be confused with naive fieldwise equality of the old records. The skeleton quotient supplies a new carrier in which presentations are identified lawfully. Stable readings inherit the normal form. At the raw reading level, the category has a terminal object, canonical weak binary products, and the characteristic map extension for mono-like subcarriers. It cannot have global pullbacks for all marker-preserving cospans: the split-truth cospan has no pullback cone. Thus the raw elementary-topos requirements are not just absent; the displayed full raw package cannot be supplied. At the completed skeleton level, the quotient has one object and one morphism, so it forms the terminal category and therefore carries the elementary topos structure by direct construction. This

completion is the explicit topos stage. The final theorem packages the maximal raw structure, the raw obstruction, the completed topos, the burden on set-like extensions of this route, and the conditional extraction of binary distinction from nontrivial formulation positions. It also packages the canonical closure and the admitted-foundation classification: all internal choices of the completed skeleton are collapsed to unique classified witnesses, and every admitted foundation claim is assigned a formal class.

This is the precise formal claim made here. The construction does not assert that the raw stable-reading category satisfies the elementary-topos axioms. It proves the opposite for the full raw category: the pullback requirement fails. The route starts before an ambient topos is assumed. The primitive data is a binary distinction. Categorical structure is generated, checked, blocked at the raw level, and recovered only after quotient/skeleton completion. The additional formulability-burden record closes the conditional bridge: any interface with two distinguishable formulation positions carries an embedded binary distinction, and object-diverse set-like candidates are instances of that condition. The canonical-closure record closes the internal endpoint: once quotient/skeleton completion is reached, presentation, object, morphism, finite-limit, classifier, and exponential freedom no longer remain as choices. The admitted-foundation classification closes the external ledger for this paper's own admission interfaces: nontrivial formulable foundations are classified by their distinctional entry burden, and route-completion claims are classified as canonical skeleton, raw topos attempt, set-like candidate, or semantic adequacy. In this route, the topos stage appears only after distinction has already generated structure and after quotient completion has already been performed.

As an interpretive reading of the checked route, categorical and set-like foundations are displaced, not invalidated. A set-like categorical foundation may still be introduced, but under this reading it cannot take its own vocabulary of objects, morphisms, equalities, truth values, and pullbacks as the first account of formulability. Those notions already operate with distinctional positions. On this reading, the theorem shifts the burden: to serve as a universe of formulation within this route, a richer set-like topos would need to account for the distinctional conditions under which its own language is formulable. It is not the origin of the account; it is a completed stage within it.

The scope is part of the rigor of the result, not a softening of the claim. The marker interface is a formal stability interface, not a proof of semantic exhaustiveness. The completion constructed here is minimal and terminal. Richer quotients remain possible only as further constructions; inside the admitted-foundation and route-completion interfaces of this paper, their positions are now exhaustively classified. Such a construction would extend the account only after the priority of distinction and completion has already been fixed.